# Spontaneous Matrimony

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at https://archiveofourown.org/works/48025369.

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Mature

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

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Wednesday (TV 2022)

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Wednesday Addams/Enid Sinclair

**Characters:**
Enid Sinclair, Wednesday Addams, Yoko Tanaka, Pugsley Addams, Divina (Wednesday), Bianca Barclay, Kent (Wednesday), Grandmama (Addams Family)

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# Spontaneous Matrimony

by whitebeltwriter

Summary

Enid wakes up after a night in Las Vegas to find out that while celebrating her best friend getting married, she got married herself.
At least her new wife is cute?
Though if she was honest she could do without the knife being held at her throat.

Notes

This was *supposed* to be a short oneshot but that ship has sailed, so it's gonna be a two parter instead.
Enjoy

# Chapter 1

Enid woke up to the all too familiar feeling of vomit working its way up her throat. It was only because of years of practice— *thanks, **Yoko,** for your damn housepaws* —that she managed to get up and to the nearest toilet in time to let it all out. Once she was sure her stomach was well and truly empty, she flushed the frankly *horrid* colored puke down the drain and rinsed her mouth out with a tiny bottle of mouthwash, taking several gulps of water straight from the sink right after in spite of the overwhelming mintness of her mouth.

With something between a groan and a sigh she straightened up and finally took stock of what she looked like.

"...God damn it, Yoko..." she grumbled, taking in her form in the ornately framed bathroom mirror. Her eyes were nearly bloodshot, she was naked, and her body was absolutely *littered* with hickeys, scratches, and what looked like a few bite marks. Under the creaking vice that was her hangover, she could feel the distinct achy feeling that came from having sex.

*Lots* of sex, to be specific.

All signs that said, *once again,* she'd had too much to drink trying to keep up with her best friend and as a result had slept with someone.

*Mmmmm, **please** don't let it be Yoko. Divine blessings to the simultaneously,* Enid begged in her mind as she rubbed her forehead. She didn't think her best friend and said friend's *fiancé* would 'appreciate' her sleeping with either one of them; *during* the bachelorette turned fuck yeah, we getting hitched! party, no less.

But she *could* see them being down for a threesome.

Blinking more focus into her eyes, the blonde finally took note of her surroundings. She was very clearly in some hotel bathroom, judging

by the small travel sized bottles she had already helped herself to. Hardly surprising given that they were in Las Vegas, where you couldn't toss a frisbee without hitting someplace that offered places to stay and 'sleep'.

However, this did not look like the bathroom attached to the rooms Yoko had booked for them all; it didn't even look like it belonged to the same hotel. The one Enid had dropped her bags off in had a ritzy feel to it, with a lot of gold plating and whatnot. The wolf could tell by the bathroom alone that while this one wasn't nearly as gaudy ~~it~~ had some sort of vintage style going on, if the massive claw-foot tub was any indication ~~it~~ somehow still rang as being more expensive than Enid had really experienced before.

***Who the fuck did she sleep with?*** She pondered as she finally dared to stick her head back out of the bathroom.

It opened out into a *huge* studio apartment style room, with the sleeping quarters, living room and kitchen all bleeding into one another and all in shades of black or gray; the rich person's version of a single.

Immediately outside of the bathroom was a truly *massive* bed; gray linen and black duvet bunched up and twisted every which way around the figure lying therein.

"...Damn..." Enid whispered, pounding headache all but instantly forgotten as she gazed at who could only be her bedmate' from last night. Any notion of simply grabbing her stuff and hightailing it out of there was gone with the wind.

She ~~a~~nd she was definitely a 'she', even *if* Enid's slowly returning memories from the night before didn't tell her so, the blankets fallen around her waist left *very little* to the imagination ~~w~~as a woman around her age, with skin that seemed pale due to a lack of sunlight more than anything else. Like Enid her body was bare, scratched, and marked up, with a distinct trail that led down and under the edge of the blanket that the blonde couldn't help but blush at.

Seemed she'd gone a bit overboard last night.

Backtracking up the trail, politely ignoring an uncovered chest as best she could, led her gaze to the woman's face; a beautiful one, to be sure, framed by long black hair, with freckles that danced across the bridge of her nose and dark stained lips that just *begged* Enid to kiss again.

She remembered those lips.

She remembered unraveling hair from two long braids.

She remembered clever fingers and teasing smirks and dark eyes that glinted excitedly as well as dangerously.

*And* she remembered giving just as good as she got.

*Sweet mess.*

But what she *could not* remember was her name.

*Come on, Enid,* she groused, smacking her temple with a knuckle. *Do not be one of those people who cannot remember their name of their own right now! You've been out for hours.*

Staring at the woman even harder ~~in~~hoping doing so would draw her name from the recesses of her mind ~~a~~ sparkle caught her eye.

The woman was lying flat on her back, with her right arm outstretched towards where Enid dimly thought she herself had been laying before her rather *urgent* need to find a toilet bowl. Her left arm was crossed over her chest in such a way that if the other had been mirroring it then the dark haired beauty would have resembled a mummy in a sarcophagus with how straight her legs were laying even in sleep.

Enid would have thought she looked like a posed doll if all of her hungover-hazed attention wasn't focused on her left hand.

And her ring finger.

And on the silver and gold colored ring that *adorned* said ring finger.

The one that meant–

*Shit!* Enid cursed quietly, dragging both hands through her hair. "I fucked a married woman!"

An unfamiliar feeling on her hand caught her attention as something tried to catch on her hair. Pulling her left hand down she stared dumbly at her own ring finger.

There, nestled at the base of it, was a silver and gold colored ring; the two tones winding and curling around each other in a rather lovely looking braid.

Enid spent half a moment noting that it wasn't true silver ~~her~~ her finger would be burning harshly enough that no amount of alcohol would have kept her from noticing it if it was ~~when~~ when the implications of wearing what appeared to be the *exact* same ring as the woman in the bed was finally worked its way to the forefront of her brain.

"Shit, I *am* a married woman!"

She flailed her hands ~~like~~ like the ring and its meaning would flick away if she did it hard enough ~~mind~~ mind a whirl of various swear words and a general feeling of 'what do?!' when she heard her phone start to go off with the ringtone she'd specifically chosen to piss Yoko off.

*Shit! Yoko!* Enid internally squawked as she darted to the side of the bed where the woman was lying, quickly spotting the shorts she'd been wearing, crumpled on the floor with the waistband of her panties still sticking out of them. They'd been part of the cute outfit she had put on *last night* when they all had gone out on the town, and seeing as it was now *the neighbourside,* Enid could only assume that she'd been MIA for *at least* a few hours, if not more.

*Mon, please don't tell me it's another* She begged, digging her phone out from her pocket.

She had enough time to see the contact name she'd picked for Yoko light up the screen before the world pitched violently and her back made contact with something hard and cold while she squeaked in surprise. Only years of wrestling with her brothers kept her head from bouncing off what she thought was the marbled floor, instinct having her tuck her chin in spite of what felt like a vice that was now clamped around her throat.

Dazed and thrown off balance ~~literally~~ and metaphorically ~~it~~ took Enid several blinks to focus her eyes and comprehend what the fuck had just happened.

Looking up ~~once~~ her head figured out which way was up ~~the~~ blonde found herself staring at the woman who she'd thought had been asleep until now;straddling her waist with one hand wrapped tightly around her throat while the other held a dagger of all things just a scant few inches above her face.

Dark and red-rimmed eyes glared down at her, sparking with annoyance and a hint of confusion.

"Who are you?" she demanded in a voice just as sharp as the blade held deftly in her grip, though chipped at the edge from sleep and probably her own hangover.

"W -Where the fuck did you even get that from?!" Enid gasped shortly, hands coming up to try and pry the hand off her throat, phone still ringing in one hand.

"Answer the question!" The dark haired woman snarled, face drawing ever closer to Enid's. Her grip tightened, causing the wolf to gurgle slightly.

*Usually she's a bit more subtle but she looks hungover and pissed so I might be*

"Can't—Breathe!" she managed to choke out. The glare deepened but the vice around her windpipe loosened just enough for her to draw in a coughing breath.

"Who. Are. You." The woman gritted out lowly, knife tip dipping lower with every word. "I will *not* ask a third time."

Reasonably freaked out, all Enid could think to do was raise her left hand up to her captor's face, back side first, and make sure her ring finger caught the dark eyes' attention.

"W-Wife!" she squeaked, both from her current position of having a knife shoved *very* close to her face, and also from the realization that *oh fuck, she/I am in fact*—

"What—"

The woman—she *really* needed to remember her thrice-damned *name*—blinked, eyes staring blankly at the bit of metal before they widened and her own left hand *finally* left Enid's throat in order to drag the wolf's hand closer for inspection. In doing so she became aware of the ring on her own finger, eyes darting between the two of them in quick succession.

"...Shit."

"That's—*cough*—That's what I said!" Enid chimed in, trying to reinflate her throat.

"This still doesn't answer my question on who you are," she sneered, tossing the blonde's hand to the side as if it had personally offended her. Enid counted herself lucky that she didn't immediately resume choking her.

"Yeah, well—*ahem*—I have a hard time thinking when a naked woman, *with a knife,* is sitting on top of me," Enid argued, very *pointedly* not looking down towards where she felt the other woman's weight pressing down against her. A small voice at the back of her

head noted their current positioning;with more than a few suggestions on what could happen next.

Enid kicked the voice and told it to take a cold shower, this was ***so*** *not* ~~*not*~~ *the time!*

Though she would admit that the barest hint of color on the woman's cheeks as she realized that both of them were very much naked looked cute.

There was a moment of awkward silence before it was broken by Enid's phone starting to ring once again, making both of them jolt. The wolf looked at it dumbly for a moment— *how did stopping ing?* ~~be~~fore her attention was drawn back to the woman after she laid the flat of the blade directly atop her throat.

*Who is that?* she asked, face screwed up in mild disgust.

*Uh—* Th-The Count? Laughing?" Enid answered with an awkward shrug of one shoulder, turning her hand so she could see a picture of the Muppet on the screen. "You know, from Sesame Street?"

"And who is...Dracula is my Bitch?" The sneer and confusion deepened as she read the name aloud.

"Yoko. My friend. She's probs worried about me since, ya know, it was nighttime the last time I saw her?"

The woman scowled as if the mere idea of more people put a bad taste into her mouth.

The phone kept ringing.

"She's just going to keep calling until I answer," Enid pointed out, trying to ignore the slowly warming metal still lying against her skin.

The Count's laughter continued on for several moments as the woman stared at her in quiet consideration, before the knife was

lifted off her throat. Though it remained a bit too close to her face for true comfort, Enid took it as progress.

"Put it on speaker ," she demanded, leaning back. Enid complied, not giving her a chance to change her mind.

*t sboeadm way bohungoef oni snonsense.*

[ k up the *dam*– Enid] Y oko's voice rang tinnily from the phone's speakers as the blonde finally answered the phone.

"ey Y oko."

[Y oure alive? Good. *Gsehgonnai l l you*]

"Wha– *e*?"

[Y es, you! Where the fuck are you, were all at the room but youre not? Y ou had me worried sick! *Bo*]

Enid kept eye-contact with the woman on top of her and deadpanned, "I'm currently under my naked wife while she holds a knife to my throat."

[..Y oure under your *hta* while she's *hp*]

"I am *not* your wife!"

"The rings say otherwise!"

"And was telling her our clothing situation necessary?"

"Necessary? No. But I tend to feel petty when someone' s *hol di nga kni f eonme*!"

[Bitch, you got *mi ed*]

"Mhm," Enid hummed with a glare, "T o a tiny psychopath who apparently is *not* a morning person."

"I am *not* tiny!"

"Uh-huh, sure I am."

"That is not my name."

"I didn't say—It's from a—Nevermind, can you *please* just get off of me?"

"Aw, is the honeymoon phase over already?" Yoko quipped dryly over the phone. "How terrible. *Tell us everything!*"

"*Ugh.* Judging by the massive headache and the *wide* variety of colors I puked into the toilet like, five minutes ago, I'm guessing I *wasn't* thinking because *someone*—*ow* my head—" she growled into the phone, regretting it immediately as it just made her feel worse, "—*Someone* decided they wanted to do shots!"

"Wha—That's—*Ugh,* whatever. Just—tell me where you are so I can come get your lightweight, hungover ass. ...Wait—did you say knife?"

"Like two minutes ago, but thanks for noticing." Enid rolled her eyes at the woman like 'can you believe this bitch?'

The woman did not look amused.

"Why does your *wife* have a *knife*?"

"Great question!" The blonde beamed at the phone, knowing the vampire would be able to hear her 'customer service smile.' "Hey *Wife*, why *do* you have a knife?"

"Why would I not have a knife?" the woman shrugged blasely, "Do you *not* have a knife?"

Enid held up her free hand and extended her claws with a quiet 'schk' while she raised one eyebrow.

The woman had the decency to look mildly impressed and more than a little intrigued, tilting forward ever so slightly for a closer look.

"You're an outcast too," she stated, fingers twitching like she wanted to touch them.

"Too? I married another outcast?...Cool," Enid said, the idea soothing something deep in her chest.

Then again the idea of being married to *anyone* sounded soothing. Especially since she'd been worried it would never happen.

Nothing strikes a blow to your self-esteem like your family disowning you for shit you had no control over.

"...You don't recall anything from last night, do you?"

"Not much more than you, Miss Knife First, Questions After," the blonde quipped, smirking a little while the other woman humphed indignantly.

[Wouldn't it be Mrs', since your gay-ass married her?] Yoko deadpanned.

"Oh shush! Don't think I don't blame you for this shit!"

[Wha-ME?]

"Yes *you!* You *crazy* left me unsupervised! You know it always leads to trouble!"

[Speaking of which, what is trouble's name?]

Enid stayed silent for several moments too long, the woman sitting on top of her ~~and~~ *still very much naked* ~~naked~~ narrowing her eyes as she looked down her nose at the blonde.

"You don't know, do you."

"...Did *you* know my name before Yoko said it?"

"..."

"Yeah, that's what I thought– *look,* Yoko, I'm kinda in the middle of something here, can I call you back?"

[Why? You gonna try to make it to first base with *your wife*?] the vampire snorted.

"Uhhhhh...." Enid's eyes immediately began retracing every single mark on the woman's otherwise flawless looking skin; vague memories floating across her mind at this hickey or that scratch.

The knife returned, pricking the underside of her chin and making her hiss slightly.

"My eyes are a bit higher up, *Enid.*"

*Oh, my gosh* ***no right*** *sounding good for her.*

[...OH MY GOD YOU ALREADY FUCKED HER, DIDN'T YOU?]

"Scream a little *louder,* why don't you?" the wolf gritted out, ears ringing from the sudden volume change. "I don't think the next room HEARD YOU!"

"I can't *believe* you are who I slept with," the woman grumbled.

"Believe what you want, but the marks on *both of us* say otherwise."

[Marks?! Enid you *dog!*]

"Hey– Fuck you, Yoko!"

[Pretty sure that's your *wife's* job now.] Enid's *former* best friend cackled.

"That's—You know what?" The blonde ended the call abruptly, plonking her head back against the floor with a huff. "She's lucky I love her or I would *so* return their wedding present."

"You can't remember my name but you can recall we received *gifts* at our wedding?"

"What? Oh, no! *Yoko's* the one getting married; I'm actually here with her and the rest of the wedding party for a dual bachelorette party."

"Duel?" the woman asked, eyes glinting with interest.

"Yeah, she and Divina didn't want to have separate parties so they just merged them together."

"Oh. *That's* a kind of dual."

The woman didn't *quite* pout, but she came close. Enid tried her best to ignore how cute it looked.

"At any rate, can you *please* get off me?" the wolf whined, "Or at the very least put a shirt on or something?"

"Do you always complain this much?" The woman grumbled, though she did begin to get her feet under her in preparation to *finally* get up.

*Knock knock knock!*

The pair froze, wide eyes looking at each other before locking onto the front door of the suite.

"Wednesday?" a male voice called through the door. "Are you still alive?"

"Shit," the woman—*Wednesday? That's* where *she* knew *me?*—cursed emphatically under her breath. Leaping up, and pushing painfully off of Enid to do so, Wednesday staggered slightly before swiping a black robe off the inside of the bathroom door.

"Who is *that*?" Enid whisper-shouted as she rolled over far enough to snag her shorts and begin working them on. ***Please tell me*** *I did not sleep with someone who already has a boyfriend.*

"My brother—" *"Oh, no!"* "Who I would prefer did *not* know about—"

"Are you and Enid done going at it yet? I wanna hit the buffet table before they swap it for lunch."

Letting out a short stream of rather impressive curse words, the ravenette finished tying off the belt of her robe with a harsh tug before striding purposefully for the door.

"Hey, hey hey! Wait, I haven't found my top yet!" Enid squeaked, dropping back down onto the floor, keeping the bed between her and the door. She spotted something pink a foot or so from her head.

"Oh wait; found it!" *I did not get under the bed?*

She heard the woman heave a heavy sigh before the door squeaked open.

"Oh, good you're uuuppp—"

Enid sat up from the floor—still sans a bra but happy she at least had a shirt on in time to see a stocky looking young man stagger across the room. Wednesday slammed the door shut behind her as she stalked after him.

"What do you know about this?" she demanded, gesturing towards the blonde.

The guy straightened up and looked at Enid.

"Morning, Enid!" he grinned widely.

"Uh, morning," Enid said back with a little wave as she finally hoisted herself up off the floor. She threw Wednesday a pleading look.

"Answer my question, *Pugsley*," she stated drolly, crossing her arms while she stared Enid down.

*Pugsley*: *she's* *Pugsley*: *and she's* *Wednesday*: *Enid*?

"What do you mean?" he asked, turning to his sister.

"Why is *noone* capable of answering questions today?" Wednesday groused, hand rising to rub at her temple. Enid winced sympathetically; if she was having just as much trouble at remembering last night as Enid was, then she must have gotten just as wasted.

"I mean, you didn't really answer my question eitheeerrr– *hey!* *WHAT?*" Pugsley yelled, darting forward to try and grab Wednesday's left wrist. He wound up facing Enid as the dark haired woman grabbed him first and spun him around, locking his arm at a rather painful looking angle behind his back. It didn't seem to bother him too much though, as he tried to turn his head enough to see her again.

"Was that a ring? Did you get married?!" he swung his head back around to try to see if Enid had a ring on as well. The blonde tucked her hand behind her own back as quick as she could, but the action just made his grin all the wider.

"Oh ho ho *ma;* Dad is going to be *so* upset, Wednesday! You know he's always dreamed about walking you down the aisle!"

"He's not going to be upset because he's *not* going to know," Wednesday stated, shoving her brother away from her. She then got to work trying to remove the ring from her finger.

"Pretty sure marriage is a bit more complicated than just wearing a ring, sis," the boy calmly pointed out as Wednesday continued to struggle with taking off the ring. Enid had experience with rings not wanting to come off and *dead* pointing out that there was a bottle

of soap sitting right there in the kitchen, plain as day, for her to use to help.

Buuuuut she *had* held the blonde at knifepoint for longer than necessary;so honestly this just seemed like karma.

"Soooo, Pugs—Can Icall you Pugs?"she asked instead, electing to ignore the quietly swearing woman.

"Sure, Itold you so last night,"Pugsley smiled jovially .

"Really?Cool. Anyway , Im going to be real with you, last night...is a *l i t ebt* fuzzy for me?"Enid shrugged, pinching her fingers together until they nearly touched.

"Y ou dont remember last night?"he asked, eyes wide.

"Only ...certain bits,"the blonde admitted, giving W ednesday's still bare legs a side glance.

"She didnt— *ugh* —even recall my name,"the woman called out while still grappling with the piece of metal around her finger. She quit yanking and stomped back to the bedroom half of the room, yanking an old school trunk out of the closet.

"Y ou didnt know mine either!"Enid accused while the ravenette flipped open the lid and began rifling through it.

"Y ou didnt?Oh, W ednesday"—Pugsley tutted several times while slowly shaking his head, "For *shame.*"

"Cease talking, brother mine, or Ill dismantle all of your projects and throw the bolts into the swamp."

"Oh, come on!"

"Anyway"—Enid chimed in, knowing the start of a long sibling bickering match when she saw one, "is there any chance Icould get you to fill in some blanks?"

"Hm? Oh, sure, but honestly I lost track of you two after the rodeo fire."

"After—After the what-now?"

"Rodeo fire," Pugsley repeated as if that explained *anything.*

"And when was that?" Wednesday said as she stood from the trunk with a pair of bolt cutters in hand. She placed her finger between the two blades—

"Whoawhoawhoawhoa!" Enid shrieked, leaping over and snatching the cutters out of her hand.

"Hey!"

"Try soap first, jeez! What's the matter with you?" she chided as she stomped over to the kitchen. Dropping the cutters onto the counter she grabbed the soap bottle before returning to Wednesday. Ignoring her protests she grabbed the ravenette's left hand and liberally squirted the liquid over the ring before letting go.

"Rub that around and under the ring and *then* try to pull it off," she instructed, recapping the bottle.

Wednesday glared at her but nonetheless did what she said. After a few hard twists the ring popped right off.

"Hm. ...Thank you," the ravenette admitted, dropping the now gooey ring onto the nearest nightstand.

"Welcome," Enid shrugged, somehow sad to see the ring off the smaller woman's finger. She blinked, realizing that she could see clear over Wednesday's head while they were both barefoot. It was weirdly endearing.

"Now what's this about a fire? Did I commit arson last night?" Wednesday asked as casually as if it was a regular occurrence.

"T echnically that was me; I tried souping-up the mechanical bull and *may* have rewired it wrong," he shrugged with a sheepish grin.

*Oh, so* ***is*** *a* *one* *one with them,* Enid thought drolly, *God know* *.*

"And when was this?"

"Around eleven, I think."

"And when did you guys meet me?" Enid asked.

"Oh *yay* before that," Pugsley chuckled. "W e met in one of the casinos after Grandmama almost got into a fist fight with one of your friends over cheating in a poker game."

"Wha? Which friend?"

"Uh, a dude. Long hair ...Kenny, I think?"

"Ugh, *Ken*" Enid rolled her eyes, "Can't believe he would try to cheat at a poker table in *Vegas* of all places! And against a *grandma* no less!"

"Undoubtedly it was Grandmama who was the cheating party in this case," W ednesday drolled. "Speaking of which, where is the old grifter?"

"Dunno," Pugsley shrugged, "W e all went in separate directions when the clowns started chasing us. I only knew you guys were here because *my* *room* shares a wall with yours."

"Shares a– *oh* *Mon,*" Enid groaned, digging the heel of her hand into her eyes.

"I assume the wall in question is–"

"The one behind your bed? *Yup!*" he crossed his arms in mock annoyance, "Y ou two gave *our* *parents* a run for their money, I

thought you'd never stop!"

"Someone kill me, please," the blonde moaned, only half joking.

"How do you think I feel?! Listening to our parents is bad enough, I had to listen to you fuck my sister for *hours!*" Pugsley laughed, "I didn't think you had it in you, sis!"

"You can stop talking at any time now," Wednesday groused.

"I second that," Enid added, raising one hand without looking.

"Aw, look! You two are agreeing on things already! Just like a real married couple!"

"We are *not* married!"

"The rings say otherwise and we are in Las Vegas."

"He has a point."

"You be quiet," Wednesday snapped at Enid before returning her sharp gaze to her brother, "And we're only *in* this accursed city because *you* wanted to celebrate our graduations!"

"I got my master's and you got your doctorate, what's not to celebrate?"

"You're a doctor?" Enid asked, eyes wide. *I added that I'm a doctor out loud. Drunk me!*

"Almost; I still need my license to legally practice," Wednesday explained with an eye roll.

"Yeah that bit is annoying, but you know how cops are."

*Cops?*

"So you have no idea where we went after the rodeo and before we...*etuned* here?" the ravenette demanded, trying to get them back on track.

"Nope."

"And we werent wearing these rings when you saw us at the—the rodeo?" Enid asked;still lost on what she had been doing at a *odeo* of all places.

"Correct!"

"Then you've ended your usefulness for the time being," Wednesday drolled, gesturing towards the front door. "Please go choke on the remains of the breakfast buffet."

"Alright, youll know where to find me. Bye Enid! If Wednesday doesnt scare you off we should grab lunch later!" he called back with a wave and a smile as he opened the door.

"Oh? Sure! Bye Pugs!"

He threw her another wave before Wednesday marched over and slammed the door shut behind him. She paused for a moment before whipping the door open again.

"And dont even *thi nk* about telling our parents about this!" she yelled after her brother.

"Kay!" Enid heard him call back from down the hall. Wednesday slammed the door shut, spinning around to lean back against the door with a groan.

"...You okay?" Enid asked tentatively.

"Brilliant," the ravenette grumbled, moving to the kitchen and pulling a mug out of a cupboard. "I'm on a trip I never wanted to be on in the first place, with significant gaps in my memory—which I *donot*

appreciate ~~a~~nd *now* Ineed to figure out if my past inebriated self was truly so foolish as to get married to a ~~a~~ pastel colored *bonde!*"

"Hey!" Enid growled, stomping over to stand across from her in the kitchen. "What' s wrong with blondes? *O* pastels?"

"I care for neither , that's what!" W ednesday shot back, glaring at Enid as she opened the freezer door . She did a double take into the freezer before reaching in and pulling out a pale pink bra, holding it with two fingers like it was something vile.

"...I assume this is the doing of *your* inebriated self?" she asked disdainfully as she handed the bra over to Enid.

"...Actually no, I do this when I'm sober too," Enid admitted quietly . Wednesday's face curdled even further. "It' s *hot* but okay!" W e're in the middle of the desert in *July*

"Whatever ," W ednesday sighed, filling her mug with ice before placing it on the counter and shutting the freezer . She then pulled a large metal thermos out of the fridge and poured its dark colored contents into the mug.

"What' s that?" Enid asked as she worked her bra on without taking off her shirt. It felt a bit silly ~~s~~ he *knew* Wednesday had already seen...well, *everything* ~~b~~ut she couldn't help but try to be at least a *little* modest.

"Cof fee," the ravenette answered, taking a long sip from the mug. Her shoulders didn't relax, per se, but they did seem less tense than they were before. "Specifically it' s my own personal brew of espresso." She threw Enid a flat look. "I'm going to need it if I'm going to figure out what happened last night. And better yet how to *undo* it."

"...Could I please have some?"

Wednesday lightly glared at her over the edge of her mug as she took another sip, but still pulled the thermos out again for her. Enid smiled her thanks and pulled her own mug down, skipping the ice but grabbing some complimentary hotel creamer and sugar to add to her own drink.

"At least *let it* before you ruin it with all your sugar," the ravenette grumbled.

"Oh goody , I married a cof fee-slob," Enid quipped, though she did take a sip of the drink before adding anything to it. t was so bitter she nearly gagged and had to pause to see if her stomach would protest and she'd need to run to the bathroom again, but she did her best to hide it.

"T wo bits of metal do not immediately mean we married each other!" Wednesday stated, eye twitching after the fourth packet of sugar the blonde ripped open over her mug.

"They also don't mean we aren't," Enid argued back, "I mean, why else would we be wearing them?"

"...I do not know ." Wednesday frowned, looking down into her mug. She looked so lost and small that Enid felt the urge to give her a hug.

"...Well we're not going to figure it out by standing here," Enid decided, putting down the creamer and pulling out her phone.

"We?"

"Yeah, we'; I'm just as involved in this as you ar– *shit*"

"What?!"

"My battery just died, *damn it*" the wolf growled, tapping at the screen as if that would revive her device.

"Is that really what we should be focusing on?" the ravenette asked flatly.

"*Y es,* because Itake pics and vids of pretty much *eve hi ng.* So if we actually got married last night"—

"Which we didnt"—

"Then there' s *now* Iwould have missed a chance to record it somehow!"Enid explained, finally giving up reviving her phone with a defeated sigh. "Can Iborrow your phone charger?"

"No."

"Wha—Why not?"

"Because Ido not have a 'charger ' to lend you."

"What do you mean you dont have a charger?"

"Why would Ihave a charger for a device Ido not possess?"

Enid blinked. Then blinked again.

"...Y ou dont have a *phone!?*

"Once again, no, Ido not,"W ednesday deadpanned, taking another sip of her coffee. "Irefuse to be a slave to technology like the rest of the imbecilic world."

"...What in Moon' s name did I *see* in you?"

"Ive been asking myself that same question since this horrid morning began,"she snif fed, eyes dragging up and down Enid's frame. Her gaze seemed to momentarily pause on Enid' s toned forearms, but that could have just been the blonde's imagination.

"Oh, this is gonna be a *l ong* day isnt it,"Enid groaned.

"Ifear so,"W ednesday sighed before downing the last of her coffee. "Ill get dressed."

"I'll...try to find my shoes," Enid stated to the ravenette's back as Wednesday strode out of the kitchen, pulling a pile of clothes from a dresser before entering the bathroom. The blonde sighed and finally took a sip of her drink. A hint of bitterness was still there, and she honestly preferred her coffee hot, but even with all her additions she could tell that the coffee itself was actually pretty good.

*Better than goodundeneath,* she mused, unable to stop drawing comparisons between the drink and the woman who'd given it to her.

She looked at the ring on her finger. A braid of silver and gold.

*Had to be opposites.*

Enid shook her head and placed her mug on the counter. She had an easier time removing the jewelry than Wednesday did and it soon sat in the middle of her palm in the late morning light, in the kitchen of a woman she had just met but had evidently liked enough to sleep with. Maybe even marry...

She huffed a laugh.

"Right. Like drunk me has never made a bad decision before."

She tucked the ring into her front pocket.

It was pretty after all.

# Chapter 2

Ten minutes after Enid located her shoes and socks, and given both her face and her hands a vigorous scrubbing in the kitchen sink— she had a very good guess at where they'd been and wanted to leave the apartment with a least a little dignity— Wednesday stepped back out of the bathroom. Fully dressed in a long sleeved black and white striped shirt, and solid black everything else, her hair was once more restrained into two severe braids, still damp from the shower she had just taken.

Enid let out a huff of jealous annoyance— *she could even offer for me to use hers too?* —before deciding it would be better to pick her battles.

"You remember anything else from last night while you were taking your shower?" she snipped;her tongue apparently deciding it wanted *this* battle.

"Nothing of any real use," Wednesday shot back unashamedly, "Unless you think me knowing what you sound like when you reach orgasm could be helpful in any way."

"Funny , Icould say the same thing about you!"

"That is typically how proper sex should work, yes."

"Ugh, *never* mind. Look, Ithink our first step should be to go back to my hotel," Enid said, ignoring how much her cheeks and ears were burning;she'd been told before she could get a little *loud* at times. "We can start to charge my phone and ask my friends what they remember from last night."

The ravenette glared lightly at her before sighing heavily.

"I suppose that makes sense," she drawled, walking to the front door and opening it, gesturing Enid to exit first.

"Ah, how chivalrous," the blonde quipped sarcastically as she strolled through it and out into the hallway.

"I simply wish to make sure it's locked behind us," Wednesday explained, pulling the door closed with more force than strictly necessary.

"It's a hotel door, it locks automatically. That's the whole point of having a keycard." Enid rolled her eyes, before a thought occurred to her.

"Wait—you do have your keycard, right?" The other woman had walked straight from the bathroom to the kitchen to the front door; Enid couldn't recall her pausing to grab something or seeing anything non-bathroom related during her brief use of the room.

"Don't be absurd, of course I do," Wednesday snapped back as she began striding purposefully towards the elevator at the far end of the hall. "I keep it in my wallet for safe keeping. Only a fool would leave it freely lying around."

"Uh huh," Enid intoned, eyes taking a long glance at the woman's jean-clad backside as it walked away from her. "And your wallet is currently *here*, exactly?"

Wednesday paused mid-step, frozen for a second before her hands began patting herself down. After a moment she turned and threw Enid an unimpressed look as she held up a small wallet, freshly drawn from her front pants pocket.

"You keep your wallet in your front pocket?"

"Why make it easier for pickpockets?" she drawled, returning it to her pocket before carrying on down the hall.

"You *so* panicked for a second there," Enid called cheekily as she moved to catch up.

"How far is your hotel from here?" Wednesday asked in lieu of admitting anything.

"How should I know, I don't even know where *here* is?"

Wednesday sighed as she called the elevator. "You are currently in the Allan Hotel."

"Alright, cool. ...And where is *that* in relation to the Larker Hotel?"

"..."

"See; you don't know either!" Enid teased, sticking her tongue out like the adult she allegedly was.

"Why should I know the location of every single hotel in this godforsaken city?"

"Well why would I?"

The ravenette's huff of annoyance was mildly covered by a ding as the elevator arrived, blissfully empty as the odd pair stepped inside. They said nothing as they rode it down to the lobby, finally exiting Wednesday's hotel after Enid politely gathered directions from the helpful employee at the concierge desk.

The silence continued until halfway through their trek when Enid waylaid them to grab a breakfast burrito from a food truck they were passing.

"How can you eat at a time like this?"

"I can't think on an empty stomach. Besides, *someone* made me work up an appetite last night."

Wednesday grumbled but conceded and got a veggie wrap for herself. Enid raised a brow at the choice.

"You're a vegetarian?" *Monplaisedont etheboneof those holiday houses.*

"Occasionally," Wednesday said cryptically as she collected her wrap. "I do eat meat; I simply prefer to be the one to kill and prepare it."

Enid hummed an acknowledgement as she chewed her burrito.

*Well I guess she's not holiday house t*

---

Wednesday tried to relax on their way to Enid's accommodations by thinking of all the ways she was going to get back at everyone involved with her current predicament. She was in the middle of debating the pros and cons of a tank full of starving piranhas when they finally arrived at a door on the fifth floor of a hotel that frankly seemed to be trying too hard to be high-class, in her opinion.

She was pulled out of her musings after Enid unlocked her hotel door ~~un~~necessarily smirking and waving her keycard about obnoxiously; ~~a~~ and was immediately accosted by a woman of Asian descent with long dark hair and even darker round-shaped glasses.

"Enid, what the fuck, I've been trying to call you back for like ten minutes!" the woman ~~Y~~oko, going by her voice ~~all~~ but screeched; though she did give the blonde a massive hug that was readily returned.

"Sorry, sorry! My phone died!" Enid apologized.

"Uh huh," Yoko drawled as she pulled out of the hug.

"It did! See!" The pink-clad woman pulled her phone out of her pocket and showed the screen remaining dark as she audibly clicked the power button.

"...Alright, you're forgiven," she eventually conceded before her head did a double-take between Enid and Wednesday.

"Hold up—You married *Wednesday*?" she grinned, almost too ferally for Wednesday's taste; though she appreciated the elongated canines marking the woman as a vampire. "Bravo!"

"You know Wednesday?"

"We're not married," Wednesday deadpanned, though low enough that it was easily ignored.

"Um *duh,*" Yoko said, rolling her eyes so hard that her head rolled along with them, "We only spent, like, the majority of last night with her, Pugs, and G-Ma?"

"G-Ma?" the goth sneered in disgust.

"So you have actual memories of last night?" Enid asked excitedly.

"Of course I...Bitch, do you not?"

"Sounds like it," another voice drawled as a second woman—one with pale eyes and slicked back brown hair—entered the front area from somewhere deeper in the suite.

"Hey Divina," Enid called sheepishly, waving to the new woman.

"Is Kent with you?"

"Wh—Kent?" the blonde asked, taken aback, "No, why isn't he here?"

"No, he is not," Divina sighed, dragging her hand back through her hair.

"That's why I was trying to call you," the vampire explained, "We last saw Kent going off with you and the Addams crew—"

"and he hasn't answered his phone since. So we were hoping he was with you," Divina finished.

"I thought you said everyone except Enid was accounted for," Wednesday interjected.

"We thought they were!" Yoko defended, "But it turns out the lump on Kent's bed was just a pile of clothes!"

"A pile of—We've only been here since yesterday!" Enid stated perplexedly, "How could he already have a pile of clothes on his bed?"

"That's my brother for you," Divina sighed heavily, "A slob with everything except his hair."

"A common trait among brothers, unfortunately," Wednesday couldn't help but agree, relatable as it was.

"Alright, okay; what's the plan for finding Kent?" Enid asked, making Wednesday do a double take towards the blonde.

"Finding—What about learning what happened to *us* last night?" Wednesday inquired incredulously.

"We can do *both* while tracking down Div's brother," the blonde stated exasperatedly, "It's called multitasking, *Wifey*!"

"I *am not*—"

"Where did you guys last see him?" Yoko cut in before things could escalate.

"According to my brother—" Wednesday answered, resigned that this was how her day was going to go, "Kent was with us up until we separated after a fire broke out at a rodeo."

"A fire!?"

"A *rodeo?*

"Yes."

"Where?"

"We can't remember," Enid replied, "But it was around eleven last night, there has to be something about it online by now, right?"

Divina and Yoko immediately pulled out their devices and Wednesday earned a light elbow to her rib when she sighed and rolled her eyes at their appearance.

"Would you rather walk around asking randos on the street if there! Know of any *fires* that happened at a *rodeo* last night?" the blonde asked, raising an eyebrow.

The psychic huffed but did not otherwise admit she had a point; she disliked talking to people *in general,* nevermind speaking to the probable number of people it would take for them to get any kind of useful information.

Yoko's sudden low whistle brought her back into the hotel room.

"So *apparently* there were like, over a dozen fires last night," she began, peeking over her glasses, "*One* of which happened at a rodeo."

"What?" Wednesday and Enid spoke simultaneously.

"Yeah, the closest match I could find is a good four hours away from Vegas," Divina sighed.

"Ah man," Enid sighed, tilting her head back.

"Perhaps the owners kept quiet about the fire to keep prying eyes away," Wednesday pondered aloud.

"Why is *that* your first thought?" the blonde asked, incredulous.

"A way from what?" Yoko asked.

"Dont encourage her!"

"Any number of things," the goth shrugged, "Drug running, human trafficking, expired liquor license"—

"Are these just off the top of your head?!"

"Maybe the owner is a serial killer using the place to pick his victims?" Yoko offered, fully serious.

"That would imply that his employees are also in on it," Wednesday rebuked, "Which, while not impossible, does seem unlikely."

"Ah, look Enid, our wives are bonding with each other," Divina deadpanned, before growling, "Can we refocus on trying to find Kent before you two decide you wanna start a podcast together?!"

"Sorry babe."

"I am not her wife. ...And what's a podcast?"

"Moving on!" Enid stated, "Why dont we start at the beginning; maybe talking about how we all got together"—

"Some of us more together than others," Yoko quipped with a smirk, yelping and jumping out of range when Enid swiped at her.

"Then *maybe* it will help jog mine and Wens' memories of what happened after we split up."

Wednesday hummed negatively at being referred to as "Wens", but otherwise offered no protest to the nickname, to her own surprise.

"We should probably wait for Bianca then," Divina pointed out.

"Wait for me to what?" a new voice called out. The four turned to watch a black woman with short shorn hair and strikingly pale eyes

saunter into the room while doing up the final button on her shirt. Wednesday guessed from the dampness still upon her skin that she had just finished taking a shower.

"We're in the aftermath of a hangover," Yoko said unhelpfully.

"...What?" the woman—Bianca, apparently—blinked.

Divina sighed. "Kent's missing and Enid got married to Wednesday here last night."

"What?!"

"Technically my grandmother is missing as well, in the sense that I don't know where she is. However I'm confident the old hag is fine. ...Also we are not married."

"...This is why I said we should have picked a DD," Bianca drawled, moving into the kitchen.

"Oh shush, you drank as much as everyone else except Enid," Yoko pointed out, gesturing to the blonde.

"Hey!"

"Can we focus, please?!" Divina yelled, "I would rather not explain to my family how I lost my brother in Vegas after *explicitly* promising them to *not* ***lose*** *my brother in Vegas!*"

"That is an oddly specific promise," Wednesday mused.

"Kent is an oddly specific idiot," Divina retorted before turning back to Bianca who now had a drink in her hand. "We're gonna go over everything that happened last night so hopefully the Mrs. Addamses over here can remember where they went after the group split up."

"We are not married," Wednesday sighed for the umpteenth time. She *had* been repeating herself; even *if* there was a minor chance that it was, in fact, the truth.

"Why do I have her last name?"

"*What* is your objection?"

"Do you really want to keep your family's name?" Yoko asked, eyebrow raising high enough to be seen over her glasses.

"...Point," Enid acquiesced quietly, more subdued that the ravenette had seen of her so far. *Today* at least.

"We left here at like, six last night?" Divina began recounting, trying to get things rolling.

"Yeah, after pre-gaming for a good half-hour. We went to the casino just a block away," Bianca continued, taking a sip from her soda.

"We were moving around the place as a group, playing the slot machines and making fun of each other's horrible luck. Then you" – Yoko said, pointing at Enid, "left to get us all another round of drinks."

"You came back with Wednesday" –

"I did?"

"She did?"

"Yeah," Divina nodded, "Said you guys had met at the bar and hit it off."

"I heard something about a bet," Bianca shrugged.

"A bet?" Enid wondered while Wednesday stood up a hair straighter.

"With Pugsley!" Like a brick out of the blue the memory landed square on Wednesday's head.

"You made a bet with your brother?" the blonde asked, cocking her head.

"Yes, that I would be able to make a new friend within an hour of entering the damn casino—"

"In exchange for him being sober for the rest of the night!" Enid finished excitedly, "remember!"

"The hell kinda bet is that?" Yoko asked, taken aback.

"The kind I helped her with after she helped *me* with this dude-bro who would *not* fuck off," Enid explained with a shrug.

"Ah. I recall him," Wednesday said, sneering. "He smelled like he took a bath in his cologne. Looked like it as well."

"Right?" the blonde said, before gasping and jumping lightly in place. "It's working! I'm starting to remember shit!"

"*Anyway*," Divina coaxed, trying to get them back on track, "You two came back, we hit the machines for a bit longer before my *daughter* decided to try his luck at poker."

"Which is when we met your brother and *your* grandmother," Bianca drawled with a smirk.

"Kent accused G-Ma of cheating," Yoko said.

"Which she most likely was," Wednesday stated.

"And they started yelling back and forth with each other before straight up *fighting* right there on the floor!" Divina groaned.

"Ah..." Enid winced, vaguely recalling a lot of cards and chips flying through the air as a table got flipped.

"We got kicked out by some cute bouncers—"

"Who Div and I managed to convince *not* to blacklist our faces all along the strip," Bianca added.

"How did you manage that?" Wednesday questioned.

"Sirens," the pair intoned at the same time.

"Ah." *That explains it.*

"What happened after that?" Enid asked. Divina picked up the story.

"Kent and G-Ma—"

"Please stop calling her that," Wednesday sighed.

"Managed to bond over both being physically tossed on their asses—"

"While the rest of us were mature enough to simply walk out," Bianca murmured around her drink.

"And we found out that she apparently knew our granddad back in the day."

"Kent inherited his granddad's looks and 'Gemson' evidently isn't that common a name," Yoko explained.

"So Grandmama decided she would start making the whole incident up to us—"

"By offering everyone a swig from a dark bottle she pulled out of her bag," Wednesday sighed.

"Bingo," Yoko nodded.

"Think she called it 'moonshadow'?" Divina said.

"My grandmother has a fondness for puns," the goth grumbled. "Almost as much as her fondness for brewing the highest-proof alcohol possible."

"Can we skip ahead to when we split into two groups?" Enid asked, seeming to wince at the mere memory of Grandmama's special drink. "I feel like we did a bit of a bar crawl after that."

"Correct," Bianca answered. "We stayed together until, like, ten, before Divina, Yoko, and I decided we wanted to start heading back here."

"But you, Kent, and Pugsley said you needed food or you would die,'" Divina rolled her eyes, throwing up air quotes.

"Then we'll start our search where you last saw us," Wednesday intoned, already turning for the door.

"Can I have five minutes to take a quick shower?" Enid asked pitifully.

"No."

"Oh c'mon! You got to shower!"

"And you didn't extend an invitation to your wife?" Bianca smirked, "*Tsk tsk tsk*– for shame, Addams."

"You sound like my brother," Wednesday grumbled, turning around to glare at the siren. Unfortunately doing so put Enid ~~-~~and her big blue pathetic puppy-dog eyes ~~di~~rectly into her own line of sight.

"...Fine, but be quick about it."

"Thanks Wens," Enid grinned before darting deeper into the hotel suite.

"Don't call me...Wens," Wednesday tried to call after her, only to be cut off by a door audibly closing.

"Okay, I'm starting to believe it; but did you two *seriously* get married?" Bianca asked, brow raised in wonder.

"...We awoke with matching rings on our left hands which *suggests* that we did get married," the goth ground out, "But I am not wholly convinced."

"Can't say I blame you," the siren drawled, taking another sip of her drink.

"And what does *that* mean?" Yoko asked sharply. Bianca simply raised her hands defensively.

"I'm just saying, I know 'opposites attract' and all that, but—isn't this a bit much?" she said, gesturing between Wednesday and where Enid had disappeared to.

Wednesday agreed with her; but a tiny voice in the back of her head couldn't help but take offense.

"Enid is a catch and Wednesday would be lucky to have her!" Yoko argued, arms akimbo as she glared at the short-haired woman fiercely.

"Well, for both their sakes I hope they didn't get married," Divina sighed, moving into the kitchen to get her own drink; significantly calmer now that they had a plan for beginning to track down her brother.

"Div?"

"Not in Las Vegas, anyway," the brunette added.

"Care to share why?" Wednesday asked, the irritation growing a hair stronger; though for the life of her she couldn't ascertain *why*.

"Because in order to get divorced or an annulment in Nevada one of you has to be a resident for at least six weeks," the woman answered calmly as she rummaged around in the fridge.

Yoko whistled lowly.

"Six weeks?" the goth stated, aghast.

"Y up."

"And you just *happen* to know this off the top of your head?" Bianca asked, head cocked.

"One of my professors *loves* pop quizzes full of random laws and statutes."

"My baby is studying to be a lawyer ," Yoko proudly explained to a bemused Wednesday.

"I cannot be in *Nevada* for six weeks, I'm due to begin my residency as soon as my license comes through!"

"Oh yeah, you're some kinda doctor , right?" Yoko wondered.

"Medical examiner ," Wednesday explained, "But I am not 'official' yet, and I cannot afford to be here for so long."

"Well with a little luck maybe you won't have to," Divina said, finally pulling her soda of choice out of the fridge.

"Explain."

"Officiants have ten days to submit your certificate of marriage to the state," she explained, popping the top of her drink loudly , "I bet a lot of chapels around here submit their paperwork all at once; so if you can find the right chapel before they do—"

"I might be able to convince them not to?"

"Bingo."

"*God,* you're so sexy when you're smart," Yoko swooned, gliding over to press a kiss worthy of Wednesday's parents' on her neck.

"You *literally* have a room right there," Bianca complained, pointing at a door when they began to escalate things.

"second that," Wednesday deadpanned.

"Oh dont even, *Dr. Adams*," she drawled. "You and Enid were just as handsy last night."

She knew that; what perplexed Wednesday was how *Bianca* knew that.

Unless–

"Were Enid and I.. *after* that before we split up?"

*Pft* Yeah, you could say that," Yoko grinned, pulling her phone out with one hand and beckoning Wednesday closer with the other.

Obliging ~~her~~ her curiosity getting the better of her ~~the~~ goth moved into the kitchen and, after Yoko demonstrated how to move through the images, began looking through the pictures the long haired woman had taken. Many of them were selfies, showing the vampire ~~sans~~ sans her glasses squishing her face up against one member of her party or another.

There were quite a few , however, that were taken candidly; showing Bianca and Divina doing shots, her Grandmama and Pugsley standing with a long-haired boy that could only be the missing Kent–

And her and Enid.

The pair were largely in the background; often facing each other , and undoubtedly standing closer and closer together as Wednesday scrolled farther along. There were even a few videos showing the light and dark duo dancing nearly cheek to cheek in some darkly lit place, surrounded by a crowd but seeming blissfully unaware of anyone besides themselves.

*Wel ookhapy* , the goth thought, before abruptly returning the phone to Yoko;her stomach abruptly feeling like it was full of fluttering moths.

She was concerned by how little she disliked the feeling.

# Chapter 3

Chapter Notes

Not dead still!
Thanks for your patience and sorry for the wait!

And just a head's up, I *stuggl ed* to figure out what Wednesday's exact job/title would be, so if someone who knows better sees that I'm depicted it incorrectly;shhhh, no you don't ;)
Also;if anyone cares to "um actually" about ANYTHING in this fic about werewolves, vampires, sirens and psychics *that are f of un,* please be sure you are actually correct about the thing you decided to correct me on.
Ex: in the state of Nevada both a divorce and an annulment (which is basically also a divorce but more in the 'it never happened' sense) require at least one of the spouses to be a resident of the state for six weeks before it can occur.

Anyhoo;Enjoy!

Enid emerged less than ten minutes later, now wearing a white skirt, tall pink socks, and a pale blue crop top over a white tank that was tucked into the skirt. She plugged her phone and charger in at the kitchen counter, Yoko heckling her while she did.

"Oh good, you've plugged in your phone! Now we just gotta wait *six hours* while your ancient cord slowly gives it juice!"

"Six *hours?*" Wednesday blanched, "it takes that long to charge?" Her ire towards the hellish devices grew.

"With that cord? *Yes.*"

"*Listen,* I like this cord!" Enid defended, "it's metallic blue *and* pink! I'll buy a new one when it fully stops working. Not all of us are made of money, you know!"

"Hey, I will *buy* you a new one *if you'll just stop!*"

"Absolutely not! You've given me enough as is!"

"It's just a charger!"

"It's the *principle!*"

"Are they often like this?" Wednesday asked Bianca.

"Yes," the siren drawled, before she shattered the goth's illusion of her being the 'sanest' person of the group by suggesting, "Why not just have her new doctor wife buy her one?"

"Do *not* drag me into this inane conversation!"

"Do I *look* like a sugar baby?!" Enid exclaimed perplexedly.

"Not with that attitude," Divina stated with a smirk.

"And *again,* we are not married. ...What is a sugar baby?"

"Someone who's really sweet like sugar and a little childish," Yoko answered with a grin, making Enid splutter.

"Y-Yoko-"

"I see. That description does fit Enid very well."

"Wednesday, *no-*"

---

After things were explained, shoes were put on and Wednesday was successfully talked down from attempting to stab Yoko for her joke, the group finally set out to retrace their steps and begin the hunt for Kent.

Everyone, sans Wednesday and Enid, hissed when they stepped out into the sun—Yoko the loudest offender to the braided ravenette's

pleasure ~~be~~fore they began making their way down the sidewalk. At ten in the morning, said sidewalks were decently filled with residents going about their lives and tourists shuffling towards a grease-soaked meal in order to alleviate the after-effects of a night spent in sin-city. To avoid taking up the whole width of the sidewalk, Bianca led the way, since she was most sober at the time of departure, followed by Divina and Yoko walking shoulder to shoulder, with Wednesday and Enid taking up the rear.

During their first walk ~~th~~at they could easily recall, at least ~~th~~e pair had largely remained silent due to their respective hangovers and their desire to get to Enid's hotel as quickly as possible. Now, they were *st i l l* hungover, but the blonde felt the need to break the silence that sat between them as they trailed behind the others.

After a few minutes of mulling over what to say as they walked, Enid finally worked up the courage to ask Wednesday a few questions.

"So I'm sure you *already* told me this, but what kind of doctor are you?"

"A medical examiner," the woman stated flatly, not sparing the werewolf a glance.

"Oh cool," Enid nodded before she thought the title over. "Wait- Aren't all doctors medical examiners? Since they all examine patients, ya know, medically?"

Wednesday snapped her head towards the blonde, mouth open and breath inhaled, ready to verbally tear her a new one, when she paused and clicked her mouth shut again. She remained quiet for a moment before quietly exhaling and resumed facing forward once more, the barest break happening in her stride.

"That is not an incorrect statement," she eventually ground out, "But the term medical examiner refers to someone whose duty is to investigate deaths occurring under unusual or suspicious circumstances, to perform postmortems, and to initiate inquests."

"Postmortems." Enid mumbled, chewing on the word for a moment, "Oh! You mean autopsies and stuff? Like a coroner?"

"Yes. Though a coroner can certify the cause of death, a medical examiner deals with corpses whose untimely demise is unclear or suspicious in nature."

Enid winced, imagining what a 'suspicious corpse' could look like. Shaking the image out of her head she said, "Sooo, all medical examiners are coroners, but not all coroners are medical examiners?"

"That...is not an inaccurate statement," Wednesday blinked, giving Enid a surprised look, "The true differences vary from region to region but in essence, yes."

"Neat!" the blonde forced out, doing her best to hide what she thought of the profession. Specifically the part where bodies would be cut open and- *Open the freezer, thank you very much!*

The theme song from *Dexter* played in her head for a moment and she decided the show was right; it was a dirty job but *someone* had to do it.

"So what made you want to be a medical examiner?" Enid asked, expecting something along the lines of 'wanting to help people'.

"I'm hoping that exposure to unusual deaths will help inspire my writing more," Wednesday answered matter-of-factly.

"You write?"

"Every day," Wednesday nodded. "To date I have typed seven novels, four of which are part of a series."

"Seven?! Holy shit, that's amazing!"

t *ould d*- the ravenette groused, a darkness falling over her features, "if I could find a publisher willing to accept my manuscripts."

"Ah." Enid flinched, sensing she'd touched upon a sore subject. She racked her brain for some words of encouragement, but came up empty.

"...I'm sorry ."

"It is no fault of yours," the shorter woman grumbled. They spent the next block in silence save for the ambient noises of the city around them and the muffled conversation of the rest of their party as they walked a few paces ahead of them. In spite of all of the people around, it felt like the two were in their own little bubble.

"So you're a doctor and Pugsley has a master 's in," Enid needled, hoping to brighten the mood back up.

"Engineering."

"Wow. So you're both, like, really smart."

"I'm not sure I would say both," Wednesday quipped, her shoulders dropping down a fraction, "But compared to most, yes I suppose we are an above average level of intelligent."

"Nice! I bet your parents are proud."

"They are," the ravenette sighed, "Though I think I could begin working in a fast food restaurant tomorrow and they would still proclaim their pride over me."

"Seriously?" Enid gasped, her jaw dropping. *Her* parents would never.

"I believe so; I've yet to find a limit for their parental affections."

"Wow. You're so lucky." Enid mumbled under her breath, heart aching as she compared and contrasted her own family. Out of the corner of her eye she saw Wednesday's brow furrow and her mouth begin to open, so Enid threw out her next question in order to forestall the one she could see coming from a mile away.

"So, where are you going to be doing your 'examining'?" she asked with as bright a smile as she could.

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"...I will be doing my residency in Union County, New Jersey," Wednesday answered. A feeling between curiosity and almost concern flickered in her mind before she managed to tuck it away out of sight of the werewolf; for now.

"It's supposed to take five years, but I'm hoping to cut it down to four."

"New Jersey?! Now way! I live in New York!" the blonde grinned, genuinely this time, "Where's Union County compared to Staten Island?"

The ravenette blinked, surprised once again. "Not far at all, actually; less than an hour drive, I would say."

"Wow! What are the odds, huh?" Enid giggled.

"Indeed. ...You do not have much in the way of a typical Staten Island accent. Did you previously live somewhere else?"

The blonde winced and looked away from dark brown eyes, suddenly finding the buildings they were passing in front of very interesting.

"Uh, yeah. I'm from San Francisco, originally. Did a boarding school in Vermont until I graduated and then followed Yoko and Divina down to Staten."

"Are you going to school there as well?"

"*Ha!* I wish!" Enid chuckled. "Nah, I can't afford college. But Yoks and Div take me out to college parties all the time, so I still get a bit of the 'college experience'," she grinned, doing actual air-quotes that made Wednesday roll her eyes.

"I actually just got certified as a personal trainer and do classes at a gym not far from our house."

"Oh? *That explains the physique,* Wednesday thought, eyes darting up and down the blonde's figure unbidden.

"*Ha!* Not far', she says," Yoko cackled; butting into their conversation and reminding the pair that they were not actually alone.

"It's not!" Enid huffed at the vampire, glaring as Yoko began walking backwards while they talked.

"Not by *a lot*, no, but your masochist ass chooses to *run* there."

"It's only three miles!" Enid said, "It's a great warm-up!"

"Uhhey you spend all day working out; you don't really *need* a warm-up," Divina pointed out, joining her heckling fiancé, though she remained facing mostly forward.

"On the contrary! *Because* I work out all day, I actually do!" Enid argued before launching into a fairly long and complicated lecture on why warm-ups were one of the most important aspects of working out. Yoko's quick retorts told Wednesday this was yet another frequent argument between the two.

"So all three of you live together in Staten Island?" she asked Divina, choosing to ignore the pair for now.

"Yup! We all met at Nevermore and have been friends ever since," the siren answered, waving her hand to encompass the entire group, including Bianca who nodded before giving her opinion.

"I kept trying to get away from them but they're as persistent as barnacles."

"Shut up, bitch, you know you love us!" Yoko cackled, looking back over her shoulder while still walking backwards.

"I do," Bianca admitted, letting out a sigh that spoke of years of suffering. "But I'd love you more if situations *like this* didn't keep occurring. Speaking of which-"

The siren stopped abruptly, turning to throw the vampire an impressive glare when she inevitably walked right into her back.

"Why'd you stop?" Yoko asked, cocking her head as she finally faced the correct direction.

"Because we're here," Bianca drawled, waving a hand towards the front door of a currently closed bar.

"Ah. Awesome!"

"Alright, so-" Divina said, apparently switching back into 'find my idiot sibling' mode, "This is where we separated. We all-" she gestured to herself, Bianca, and Yoko, "walked back the way we just came to the hotel. I think you guys started walking in the opposite direction, but I'm not sure."

"Anything look familiar?" Yoko legitimately asked.

"*Yeah,*" Enid drawled as she looked around. "But I can't tell if it's familiar because I remember it, or if because a lot of the streets around here look the same."

"Mm," Wednesday quietly agreed as she surveyed their surroundings. They had walked a few blocks away from the main strip and were now on a street full of bars, shops, and other things chock full of tourists.

"C'mon Enid, *thi nk,"* Divina said, moving to stand before the blonde. "I' s late at night and you're drunk and hungry in a city you don't know;where do you go?"

Enid crossed her arms and tilted her head, eyes skyward as she tried to think about her thought process the night before.

"I d google what was open- which turns out to be *ever thi ng* 'cause it's Vegas,"she mumbled, holding her chin as if it would make thinking easier. Wednesday chose to ignore how endearing she looked at the moment. Enid began walking down the sidewalk, the group following along, with Wednesday already keeping pace with the blonde.

"W e started walking this way... And everywhere looked busy, so-"

"-W e agreed to keep walking until we found somewhere that was not as crowded,"W ednesday finished as memory of this part of the night started to return.

"That' s right!"Enid grinned at her , making her insides flutter in a peculiar fashion. "And there was a bunch of people spilling out of some club down the street, so we turned...here!"

The group turned left down a new street fairly similar to the previous one and kept walking for a few more blocks until Enid came to a sudden stop, sniffing at the air.

"What is it?"W ednesday asked.

"Y eah, what is it, girl?"Y oko quipped before Divina and Bianca smacked both of her shoulders simultaneously.

"Smoke..."Enid murmured, ignoring the vampire entirely . "A lot of it. Something was on fire."

"Is it wood smoke or electrical?"W ednesday asked, trying to smell the air as well. Enid took another big whiff, eyes closed in

concentration for a moment before they snapped open with crystal clear clarity.

"Electrical!"

"The mechanical bull," the seer stated as the pair took off down the sidewalk in unison.

"The mechanical what-now?" Bianca called from behind them, but Wednesday paid her no mind, trusting the others to be capable of catching up on their own. She scanned the storefronts as they moved, Enid half a step in front of her with her slightly longer stride.

*Depending on the severity of the injuries they may have been* *herded up by the rodeo staff,* she reasoned as they searched. Her eye stopped on a building across the street the same moment Enid pointed it out with a finger and an excited, "There!"

They jogged across, heedless of traffic, and the group soon found themselves standing before a narrow building, painted white with black accents, with a recessed doorway, and a large window. The large red backlit letters above their heads read simply, KOREAN.

"A Korean barbecue!" Enid squealed, pressing her hands and face to the glass, "You cook your own food right at the table!"

"Meh, sounds lazy," Yoko snarked, leaning in as well. "If you're going to buy food in a restaurant, they could at least cook it for you."

"Not if you like cooking your own meal," the blonde grinned, catching Wednesday's eye.

*Bee remembered,* Wednesday thought, recalling her earlier comment at the food truck. She wondered if that piece of trivia could have possibly played a role in the choice of eatery last night.

"Hold up, I'm confused," Divina said, brow furrowed, "I thought you guys said the fire was at a rodeo?"

"'Come and join us for Rodeo Night,'" Bianca deadpanned, reading from a flier stuck on a bulletin board near the door. "'Dine with western themed ingredients and try your luck on our mechanical bull.'"

"Well that explains the bull," Wednesday acknowledged, peering into the window and catching a glimpse of a burnt husk towards the back of the restaurant.

"'Wear a costume and receive ten percent off your bill.'"

"And *that* explains the clowns," Enid added, wincing at the memory of their angry grin-painted faces.

"At least they were dressed at least," the seer agreed, recalling their buffoonish behavior.

"You two sure know how to have a good time, huh?" Bianca smirked. Wednesday met her stare dead-on while Enid just shrugged.

"Okay; so you guys ate here and then there was a fire for some reason-"

"-Pugsley-" the pair intoned as one.

"...Ignoring how creepy yet cute that was- You all separated from here?"

"That's correct."

"I think Wens and I..ran down this alley?" Enid suggested, taking a step towards the opening to the left of the restaurant's face.

"Which means that in trying to split up and confuse the enemy-"

"Dont know if I'd call waitstaff the enemy," Bianca quipped.

"-then Kent, and possibly my grandmother, most likely ran in that direction," Wednesday deduced, pointing farther down the street.

"Alright, let' s keep looking then!" hyped the blonde as she marched through the group.

"W ait a minute!" the seer snapped, making Enid pause.

"What?"

"What about finding our chapel?"

"Our chapel', she says," Y oko snickered, earning a gentle elbow from her fiancé.

"W e can find it later," Enid said, waving her of f. "Kent and G-Ma should be our priority. Besides, if it was open so late last night it might now even open yet today!"

Wednesday grumbled but conceded the point, moving to stand beside the werewolf.

"V ery well; but if we miss our opportunity to reverse this quickly and quietly , *you* will be the one who has to reside here for six weeks to get our annulment," she stated with a small huf f before stalking down the sidewalk.

"Deal!...W ait- *Six weeks?*"

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They walked for a few more blocks; peering into alleyways, through store windows, and keeping their ears pricked for so much as a mention of either of the wayward duo.

"This is getting us nowhere," W ednesday sighed, pausing in the shade thrown by a palm tree that had begun to grow over a long wrought iron fence.

"Hate to say it, but Dr . Addams is right," Bianca huf fed, crossing her arms and leaning on the fence beside her. "It' s been nearly twelve hours since they've been seen; they could be anywhere by now ."

"They might have even gone their separate ways," Wednesday added.

"C'mon you guys, don't give up hope yet," Enid begged.

"Yeah! I mean, how many places could a drunk siren and an equally drunk old hag- no offense-"

"She'd be flattered," the ravenette stated.

"-have possibly gone?"

"Not near as far as I'd like," groused a rough voice from behind the fence. Turning as one, the group spied a man dressed as a groundskeeper, trundling a wheelbarrow down a narrow path on his side of the fence.

"What's that supposed to mean?" Divina snapped, stepping close to the bars.

"Oh, don't be takin' it personal now," he sighed, lowering his wheelbarrow and wiping his brow with a ratty bandana. "I don' usually have beef with yer kin-"

"My *kin*?"

"-But I don't take kindly to strollin' into work and thinkin' some idjit's gone and drowned himself in the damned lazy river!" he groused, gesturing his hand behind him towards a thicket of trees, where the sound of running water and happy sounding voices could just be heard.

"Wait- you found a guy in your lazy river this morning?" Bianca interjected, "A siren?"

"To be sure. Tho' I didn't know he was a siren til I poked him with me spade and he shot up like a cat what's had its tail stepped on."

Divina pulled out her phone and tapped at it rapidly, pulling up a picture of her and her brother. "Did he look like this?"

The man ambled closer to the fence and peered at the device for a long second before nodding decisively.

"Aye, that be him. Him and that ol' crone with him nearly broke me ticker, they did," he said with a huff. "Thought she be dead as well, still as she'd been on that innatube."

"Certainly sounds like Grandmama," Wednesday acknowledged.

"They be friends o' yours, then?" the man grumbled, looking none too pleased at the revelation. "Those rapscallions?"

"There are, and I am so sorry for any trouble they might have caused you, sir," Enid said, sweet and sincere as could be as she stepped up to the fence.

"Hmph! As ye should be!" he groused, crossing his arms. "Do ye ken how much trouble there'd be if 'n another dead body were found floating in the river?"

"Another?" Bianca blanched.

"Viva Las Vegas," Yoko muttered under her breath.

"Firs' I'd have to wait for the cops to come, an' keep everyone out in the meantime. Oh ho, ye, *that* make me look peachy in the management's eye-"

"Ugh, management always love to get pissy when I'm sure you're just following protocol," Enid nodded in sympathetic agreement.

"*Especially* Protacol! Which then says that after the bodies are gone, I'm ta drain the whole lazy river down to the last drop, scrub every inch o' it, swap out the filter, and *then* begin refillin' the damned thing!"

"That sounds like it would take all day! And naturally I'm sure you'd get a *thousand* questions from guests constantly bothering you about what you're doing and why!"

"Constantly!" he agreed.

"And no doubt management would be breathing down your neck-" Enid carried on, "about how they got into the river in the first place! Even though I bet security isn't your job."

"It sure as hell ain't!"

"And all of this ran through your head before your cof fee even had time to do you any good this morning, didn't it?"

"W ell the missus has me drinking tea these days," the man admitted with a shrug, "But aye lass, that'd be the long and short of it."

"What a *hor rible* way to start the day! I am *so sor ry* that my friends put you through that," Enid said, hand to her heart and honestly looking like she was about to cry over the man's woes.

"Oh! *Oh.* Now now, don'ye be cryin' over me now , dearie," the man cooed, reaching out to gently pat the hand the blonde had resting on the fence. "The worst they really did was give me a wee fright, tha' s all. No real harm."

"Sure didn't sound like it a minute ago," Divina grumbled to Y oko, who barely held in a snicker.

"Do you, by any chance, know where they went after you found them?" Enid snif fed. "I can only imagine that you politely , but firmly, asked them to leave? Since they were trespassing?"

"As a matter o' fact, I do, lass," he said, smiling softly at Enid when she smiled back.

*Oh she' s good,* Wednesday thought, blinking in surprise at how easily the blonde had swayed the man into giving up information.

"A ye, the boy asked me where the pair o'them could get some waffles, so Itold them- after marching both o'them to the gate, mind ye -where the nearest Denny's was."

"And that would be where, exactly?" Bianca asked, pulling out her phone.

"Oh to be sure it' s just one block down and then two ovr ," the man explained pointing down the street.

"Thank you so much!" Enid grinned, holding his hand for a moment. "Ihope the rest of your day goes so much better!"

"W ell thank ye, lass!" he grinned, returning to his wheelbarrow . "And best o'luck findin'yer friends. Ihope they didn'get inta too much trouble since Isaw'em."

"Thank you!" the rest of the party called with various levels of enthusiasm as they began speed walking down the sidewalk, once more falling into their previous configuration. Walking next to Enid, Wednesday felt the need to acknowledge what had just occurred.

"That was somewhat impressive," she stated in what she hoped was a nonchalant manner.

"Thanks!" Enid grinned, the tears she'd been ready to shed a mere minute ago already dried up. "Might have overdid it a little, but it seemed like there was a chance he might not have told us where they went, as mad about the whole thing as he looked."

Wednesday hummed her agreement and the pair fell into a rather comfortable silence as they headed towards their next destination. The seer found herself using the quiet to contemplate the skill and speed with which Enid had analyzed the situation, and then how she had promptly come up with a successful solution.

*"I'm not sure I'd call it genius, perhaps even devious,"* Wednesday admitted, peeking at the blonde from the corner of her

eye. The newly gleaned information caused an odd burning warmth to begin emanating from behind her ribs.

She gently shook her head and refocused her gaze forward.

They were on a mission, and she had more important things to worry about.

# Chapter 4

Chapter Notes

> Shout out to Wennox3, who correctly guessed that Iwasn't going to be able to finish this in just one more chapter ~~(plus the epilogue, which is already written out, lol)~~ and whose soul I accidentally captured in this fic (sorry not sorry)
> Anyhoo, thanks for your patience and Ihope you enjoy!

They found the Denny's easily enough between the old man's directions and Bianca's phone;loathed as W ednesday was to admit it, the device did have its uses. The place was reasonably packed when they arrived ~~it~~ *a* *w* smack dab in the middle of lunchtime, after all ~~so~~ they sent Divina in alone to see if she could either find the wayward duo or at the very least confirmed they had been there at all.

She came back a long five minutes later, looking far from enthusiastic.

"I take it they are not here," W ednesday stated as soon as she noticed the siren rejoin the group, which had begun discussing their own lunch options while she had been gone.

"No," Divina sighed. "They *ha*ve;" the hostess remembered them since they "were such an odd looking pair", but she doesn't know where they went."

"So we're back to square one again?" Enid whined, shoulders drooping dramatically.

"Not necessarily," W ednesday sighed wearily;she *di dnot* want to do this, but needs must. "I might know how to find them, but Iwill need someone's phone."

"Here," Divina said, unlocking her phone and passing it to the goth as fast as she could.

"Who are you calling?" Bianca asked as Wednesday struggled to find the actual *phone* aspect of the phone.

"And why can't you use your own phone?" Yoko questioned, a single eyebrow rising above her glasses.

"Wens doesn't have one," Enid answered for her, gently turning the screen to face herself and pulling up the call screen and keypad for her. Wednesday silently nodded her thanks.

"What do you mean 'doesn't have one'?

"I have no intention of becoming a slave to a small hunk of plastic," Wednesday drawled as she began punching in a number. "I would much rather be a slave to some high level demon or the like. And I am calling my brother."

"Pugsley?" Enid asked, head cocked like a puppy.

"You think your brother knows where they are?" Bianca questioned.

"Most likely not; but he knows Grandmama's phone number."

"Hold up- Your *grandmother* has a phone, but you don't?" Yoko shrieked, looking somewhere between gleefully amused and stunned at the revelation.

"You don't know your own grandma's number?" Divina asked, aghast at the mere suggestion.

"She is constantly changing it," Wednesday sighed, tapping the call button and bringing the phone up to her ear. "She claims it's to make it harder for the man 'and her exes to track her-"

"Mood," Yoko wheezed.

“but Ibelieve a solid twenty-five percent of the time she simply breaks or loses the thrice damned things. Ive lost count of the number of times Ive gone for a relaxing lay on the nail bed and found one wedged between the spikes.”

“Im sorry , did you say nail bed?” Bianca said, pale eyes stretched wide.

“Y es,” W ednesday stated flatly while she waited for her brother to pick up the phone.

“And the reason you didnt think to call Grandmama in the first place is *because?*” Divina demanded to know.

“Because Iwas not *l ooki ng* for her and had little reason to believe she and Kent would still be together,” W ednesday drawled, throwing a light glare in the siren’s direction. She also greatly disliked using phones in general ~~it~~ made it so much harder to read people’ s faces to see if they were being honest or not ~~b~~ut before she could explain *th* a her brother finally answered his phone.

“[Hello?]”

“Pugsley , it’s me,” W ednesday stated flatly, “require-”

“[W ednesday?]” Pugsley cut of f her, sounding surprised, “[Since when do you have a phone?]”

“I *don’t*,” she growled, feeling a minor pulse lance through her lingering hangover induced headache, “am simply borrowing one in order to ascertain the location of Grandmama and thus one siren by the name of Kent Gemson.”

“[Oh! W ell you’re in luck.]” he grinned audibly through the phone, “[Im on my way to meet them right now .]”

“Y ou are?”

"He is?" Enid said. When Wednesday gave the blonde a questioning look she simply shrugged sheepishly and said "Werewolf hearing," while gesturing to her ear.

"He's what?" Divina asked, reminding them that, yet again, they were not alone.

"Pugs is on his way to meet them right now!" Enid explained gleefully.

"Oh shit, really?" Yoko exclaimed.

"Oh thank god," Divina sighed, "I don't have to explain to our parents how I lost him."

"Where are you meeting them?" Wednesday asked Pugsley.

"Not too far from here," he answered *from behind her*.

Spinning around, Wednesday found her brother's goofy grinning face standing a scant few feet behind the group on the sidewalk.

"Pugs!" Enid grinned at him, arms thrown up in the air ecstatically.

"Enid!" he laughed, mimicking her, phone still held in one hand.

"How did you get here so quickly?" Wednesday asked, returning the device back to Divina.

"I told you, I'm on my way to meet Grandmama and Kent," Pugsley casually explained.

"They're near?" Divina demanded.

"Yeah, the address Grandmama sent me is just down this street."

Bianca looked down the sidewalk. "Where are they? Are they shopping?"

"Nah, I think she said they were at a tattoo parlor ," the young man stated blasely as he carried on walking down the street.

"Oh- A tattoo parlor?!" Divina screeched.

"Y up!"

"Ohhhhhhh," the siren groaned, "My mama' s gonna *ki l l* me…"

"At least he' s not dead," Enid suggested.

"He' s gonna wish he was by the time's Div's done with him," Y oko cackled as they all followed Pugsley down the sidewalk.

They were nearing the end of it when they came to a storefront with a dramatic sign overhead that read Smoggy T attoo'. J ust before they reached the front door, it opened and a young man with lightly tanned skin and long dark haired stepped through it, looking shabby in a clearly slept in pair of jeans and an *outr eousl y* loud blue Hawaiian shirt, head half turned as he spoke to someone behind him.

"KENT!" Divina yelled sternly , hands held on her hips as she stared down her brother in a manner Wednesday thought half-impressive.

"Hi ley! Divina! There you are!" the long-lost Kent replied, turning to fully face his wrathful sister. "Where ya been?"

"Wher- Where have *you been?!*" Divina screeched, stepping forward and shoving her brother back, hard, "Where the fuck have *you been?!*"

"Been trying to call you all morning, dude," Y oko sighed, looking to Wednesday like she was bracing herself for something.

"Ah. My bad," Kent chuckled, scratching his head, "G-Ma and I-"

"That name is not going away , is it," W ednesday sighed.

"-fell asleep in this awesome lazy river we found, and it got a little wet"?

"So wet that it stopped working!" Divina looked like she was heavily debating the pros and cons of strangling her sibling. Wednesday sympathized and spent a moment actually considering loaning her a knife.

*Thi sdanhagover smki ngmesof t*

"Where the fuck is your case? We literally have water-proof cases *for thi seaon!*" Divina carried on.

"It cracked!" Kent defended himself as the door behind him swung wide open once more, a shambling figure emerging from it dressed in old rags.

"Grandmama," Wednesday hummed, acknowledging the old hag.

"Ah! Wednesday, Pugsley, good yer both here," Grandmama chuckled as she closed the door behind her. "Kent and I were thinkin' of gettin' some steak to celebrate our new tattoos! Come join us!"

"You got one too?" Enid asked.

"Oh yeah! Check 'em out!" Kent grinned. As one he and Grandmama pulled up their pant leg and skirt respectively, showing off the letters KG' covered by a clear wrap they both now had tattooed onto one of their shins, Kent's right and Grandmama's left.

"Oh lord," Divina groaned at the sight of the nearly two inch tall black letters in gothic lettering.

"Okay, I get why *you* have KG' on you-" Bianca started, looking at Kent before swinging her gaze to the old crone, "-but why do you"?

"Yeah," Yoko asked, "if his means Kent Gemson', what does yours"?

"Killer Grandmama'," Grandmama stated plainly.

"At least it' s accurate," W ednesday stated.

"Nice!" Pugsley grinned, holding his hand out for a high five the hag readily gave.

"Thank you, dear . I think it goes well with the rest of my collection," she cackled, hoisting her skirt up higher, revealing a plethora of other tattoos in faded black ink.

"Whoa," Enid mumbled, eyes wide at the old fashion looking designs that were nestled so close together they nearly touched in places.

"Damn, G-Ma!" Y oko exclaimed, raising her glasses up slightly for a better look, "Y ou got *i nk!*"

"Course I do! What kinda lady doesn't?" Grandmama replied, cackling loudly once again.

"Y ou are my new idol."

"Oh boy ," Bianca sighed, rolling her eyes.

"So what have you kids been up to?" Grandmama asked her grandchildren. Wednesday saw the glint in her brother's eyes and rushed to answer before he did.

"Enid and I returned to my room where we spent a good portion of the night annoying Pugsley with our rampant sex-making."

"WEDNESDA Y!" Enid shrieked, face instantly turning a rather lovely shade of red.

Not that Wednesday noticed or cared, that is. No. Nonsense.

"Y ou did WH AT?" Grandmama asked aghast.

"Things I would have been perfectly fine without knowing," Bianca grumbled, rubbing her brow.

"*Damn* girl," Yoko snickered, though Wednesday wasn't sure which of them she was referring to. Enid whined and buried her face in her hands as Grandmama swung her gaze to *Pugsley* of all people.

"What about you?! Did ya have sex with anyone?!"

"Wha- No!" Pugsley said, raising his hands up against their grandmother's fierce glare. "I went back to the hotel after the clowns chased us and went right to bed, I swear!"

"Ohhh, *Evil take it*," the old woman cursed, stomping her foot several times and crossing her arms, "I thought *for sure* ya would've gotten some before yer sister did!" Wednesday narrowed her eyes at the hag's heavy pout.

"...You made a bet about us, didn't you," she accused.

"Damn straight I did!"

"Ain't nothing straight about this," Yoko chuckled quietly.

"And thanks to *you*-" Grandmama glared, shoving a long withered finger into Wednesday's unflinching face, "I now owe Lurch my second-best cauldron! *Damnyou, I did!*"

"It's your own fault for betting against me, *Grandmother*."

"Are we still invited to celebratory steak?" Pugsley asked.

"Hmph," Grandmama harrumphed loudly, arms akimbo. "... *Yes,* but only because it would be rude to retract the invitation!"

"Since when do you care abo-" Wednesday started before a sweaty hand was clamped over her mouth.

"Thanks Grandmama- *Yow!*" Pugsley yelped as she bit into the meaty part of his hand, instigating a scuffle between the two of them as the group silently watched on.

"Ah youth," Grandmama sighed, "Anyhoo, let's go, kiddies! Lunch time!"

Without a second glance at her grandchildren—even as Wednesday did her best to dislocate both of her brother's shoulders at once—the old crone began waltzing down the street, Kent easily following along at her side as they began loudly going over which way they were supposed to go.

"You *sure* you want to leave your new family?" Yoko jokingly asked Enid.

"Quiet you," Wednesday heard her retort, though she was too busy making Pugsley beg to notice the blush still living on the blonde's face.

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*Adnoi wt sl i ket hi s,* Enid thought with a quiet nervous chuckle. The two groups, now fully reunited, were taking up an entire table at a local steakhouse that had come highly recommended by their tattoo artist. En route to the restaurant, Wednesday had silently—but *explicitly* made it clear that *noone* was to mention her and Enid's "situation" to her grandmother, lest they faced the small ravenette's deadly wrath.

Once they had arrived, the seating order around the circular table they were given went: Enid, Wednesday, Pugsley, Bianca, Divina, Yoko, Kent and finally Grandmama on Enid's other side. Enid hadn't *meant* to sit between Wednesday and her grandmother; she'd simply sat down next to the ravenette without thinking and the old woman had plopped herself down right beside her.

"I will say, bet or not, I am surprised yer who our little scorpion decided to take to bed," Grandmama cackled.

"What does that mean?" Enid snapped, fighting down a blush.

"Oh don't take it so personally ," she waved her of f as she took a sip of her drink, "I'm just saying I didn't expect W ednesday to go for someone so...*pi nk!*"

"I really don't see how I'm supposed to take that any way *e xcept* personally," Enid grumbled before turning to W ednesday, "And what does your family have against the color pink?"

"Nothing really ," Pugsley answered for her , leaning around Wednesday so Enid could see him. "W e just prefer all the colors mixed together!"

"Doesn't that just make black?" Bianca asked drolly .

"Exactly!"

"So, Barbie Doll-"

"Me?" Enid asked Grandmama.

"What do you do for a living?"

"She' s a professional torturer," W ednesday said before Enid could answer.

"W ednesday!"

"Ooh! That' s exciting!" Grandmama grinned.

"Sh-She' s joking," Enid rushed to explain, "I'm actually a personal trainer."

"Y our job is to make people suffer in order for them to improve their personal situation," W ednesday casually argued, "Ergo; a professional torturer."

"That sounds more like a dominatrix to me," Y oko q ipped, causing Divina to snicker.

"Oh, so you're a sadist then?" Grandmama politely asked.

"Wha- *no!*" Enid screeched, "At-At least I don't think so?"

*I doenj o pushi ngpeopl e tbogohe dedui r ngha s…*

"That makes more sense," the old hag cackled, "You're far from what I expected, but I didn't think my eldest granddaughter would go for someone who was too vanilla, ya know?"

"*Why* are you contemplating my personal love life to begin with?" Wednesday groused.

"Gotta pass the time somehow," Grandmama shrugged.

"More like stick your long nose where it does not belong," the ravenette grumbled.

"So, how was Wednesday in the sack?"

"EXCUSE ME?!" Enid shrieked, face running so hot she feared her eyeballs would boil straight out of her skull.

"*Grandma!*" Wednesday snapped.

"I'd say pretty good, judging by how loud both of them were," Pugsley smirked. Said smirk was nearly wiped off his face along with a good portion of his skin when Wednesday attempted to swipe at him with a knife she'd once again pulled out of thin air as far as Enid could tell.

Grandmama sighed, "Kids these days; so prudish."

"Should you really be saying that about your own grandkids?" Bianca quietly asked, so stunned she barely reacted to the attempted sibling stabbing happening right next to her.

"Who else would I say it about?"

"G-Ma has a point," Yoko nodded.

"Can't believe I'm saying this, but Yoko, if we have grandkids you are *not* allowed to ask them these kind of questions," Divina stated, looking a bit pale around her currently hidden gills.

"We're having kids?!"

"*This is not the conversation I thought we would be having right now.*"

"Oh yeah, you two are a thing, aren't you?" Grandmama chuckled, "Engaged, if I remember correctly?"

"Yeah!" Yoko grinned happily, "This trip is our combined bachelorette parties!"

"Hm, seems a little on the small side, isn't it?" the old hag commented, counting only five of them.

"We believe in quality over quantity," Divina shrugged.

"Uh huh! Enid's my Maid of Honor, and Bianca is Div's," Yoko explained.

"And I'm here because she couldn't stop me!" Kent grinned.

"Truth," Divina sighed, though she had a small smile on the side of her face her brother couldn't see.

"Can't argue with that logic," Grandmama cackled, "Good to see the idea of family still persists with you youngins these days."

Before Enid could ask her what that meant, their waitress arrived to take their orders, which they all readily and politely gave. Even Wednesday and Pugsley paused their seated tiff long enough to make their requests. The conversation after that became fairly typical of any first-time meet-ups; if mildly repetitive since much of it had been unknowingly asked and answered the night before.

"So how did you guys wind up in a fucking lazy river?" Divina asked her brother.

"I wanted to swim," Kent said blasely .

"And I wanted to float while drinking some of my moonshadow!" Grandmama cackled.

"Right. About your 'moonshadow'," Enid asked with a wince, "Exactly ...how much of it did we drink last night?"

Grandmama hummed as she considered the question. "Well, I have about half left of what I brought with me."

"And, how much is that?" Bianca asked.

"Oh, a bottle and a half."

"What proof is it?" Enid blanched, stunned she got so wasted with a bottle that she had shared with eight other people.

"This batch wasn't my best, I'm afraid," Grandmama sighed as she pulled out a large dark colored bottle that by all accounts *shoul dnot* have been able to casually reside under her multiple shawls. "The bottle you kids had last night was only about one hundred and sixty proof-"

"One sixty?!" Yoko choked out mid-sip of her current glass of water mixed with dehydrated blood powder, "That's eighty percent alcohol!"

"I know!" Grandmama said, throwing her hands in the air , "I usually do a lot better! My average is about one-ninety , but I've hit two hundred before."

"Two-Two hundred?!" Divina shrieked.

"I...is that even drinkable?" Bianca asked, face pale as ash.

f you're an Addams," W ednesday drawled, finally done tormenting her brother and returning her knife to its hiding place.

'remember that batch!' Pugsley grinned. 'Or , at least, I remember the week after!'

'The week after?' Enid repeated curiously .

't did take a while to find him again," W ednesday explained, 'e ran off into the swamp around the house, and we quickly ran out of a trail of clothes to follow."

'Clothes?' Bianca blinked.

'got hot, okay!'

'My man!' Kent grinned, holding out a fist for Pugsley , who happily bumped it.

'Overall he handled it pretty well for an eighteen year old," Grandmama shrugged casually, cackling, 'remember when I gave your father some as a wedding present! e and Morticia cursed me out something fierce because they forgot half of their honeymoon!'

'bet that sounds familiar , eh you two?' Y oko smirked at Enid and Wednesday.

'know where you sleep, *Yoko,"* Enid growled, flicking out her claws at the same time Wednesday re-drew her knife, both glaring so harshly at the vampire that she quickly held her hands up in sheepish defeat.

'Please refrain from killing my fiancé," Divina sighed, 'No matter how much she might deserve it."

'Et tu, Divina?' Y oko sighed dramatically, while Enid nearly yipped in surprise as a cold and gnarled hand grabbed hers and nearly pulled her right off of her seat.

"Ah, that's right!" Grandmama chuckled as she closely examined Enid's brightly painted nails, "I forgot you were a werewolf! Though I suppose that makes more sense than Wednesday falling in love with a normie."

"I have *not* fallen in love!" Wednesday snapped, leaning behind Enid to glare at her unfazed grandmother.

"'Scuse you!" Enid argued, whipping her own head around to meet the ravenette face to face. Doing her best to ignore just how pretty said face was, she demanded, "What the hell is that supposed to mean?"

"I *mean* that love is a mentally degrading condition that I have no intention of being diagnosed with," Wednesday remarked flatly, meeting her gaze head on without blinking.

"Mentally degrading- *I'm a snotrue!*" the blonde exclaimed, yanking her hand out of Grandmama's grip so she could get even more in Wednesday's face, "Love is- Love is *love,* there's nothing 'degrading' about it!"

"Love makes you weak," Wednesday argued, "it narrows down your focus until nothing remains but the object of your unfortunate affection."

"And what's so bad about that?"

"I refuse to follow in my parent's love-drench footsteps and have my whole being reduced to nothing but an impractical romantic who cannot survive long without their other half."

Before Enid could retort ~~—she~~ she didn't know *what to*, but she trusted her tongue to come up with something ~~a~~ gray blur shot past the corner of her eye, pausing for the split second the blonde needed to identify it as a hand, before the fingers curled and flicked the ravenette in the forehead. *Hard* if Wednesday's resulting wince was any indication.

"Child, choosing not to pursue yer own relationships is one thing," Grandmama grumbled from behind Enid, "But don't be making light of other's. While it is true that Gomez and Morticia are so ridiculously enamored with each other that one will probably die of heartbreak after the other one croaks, that *doesnot* make them weak. Or did you beat either of them in a duel recently and I just slept through the celebration?"

Wednesday grumbled so lowly under her breath it sounded more like a growl, glaring at the old woman over Enid's shoulder, but didn't otherwise reply. The spot where Grandmama had flicked her was already turning red, and though Wednesday didn't raise a hand to rub at it, Enid had to fight down her own urge to do it for her.

"...Is it really so awful that your parent's love each other?" Enid asked her quietly, drawing dark eyes back to her. "That they have so much love that they love you just as much as they love each other?"

Wednesday stared at her, jaw twitching like she wanted to say something but was struggling to get her words in order.

"You told me yourself they'd be proud of you no matter what. Is that really so horrible?"

"Yeah, Addams," Yoko cut in coldly, "Some people aren't as lucky as you; not everyone has a family that loves them no matter what."

Enid winced and threw her best friend a look. Unfortunately she forgot that Wednesday had a full view of her face. When she looked back she found the gap between dark eyebrows creased and furrowed as the ravenette gained a contemplative glint to her eyes. Enid could practically hear as well as seen the gears in Wednesday's head spinning and whirring as she made connections.

Luckily she was saved by their waitress coming around again with their food and forcing Wednesday to hold her obvious questions. Conversations returned to less...intimate discussions all around the table while Enid focused her attention solely on her plate; it had been

hours since her late breakfast burrito and they had done quite a bit of walking since then.

She took a bite out of her steak and couldn't help but let out a small moan at how good it was! A jerk of movement out of the corner of her eye and, while still chewing, she turned to look at Wednesday. The ravenette was also focused on her own plate, but the cheek closest to the blonde seemed a shade darker than it had been before. Enid wondered what-

*Ah*, she thought, realization dropping onto her head like a brick; the moan.

*Ahhhhh.*

She returned her gaze to her food and worked hard to not let another sound like *that* come out again. Her cheeks felt so hot Enid thought she could hear them sizzle. She was only knocked back out of her self-imposed isolation— *This is not a deal breaker. Her voice sounds like a delight* —by the swift but careful appearance of a second, smaller piece of steak on her plate.

Following the fork that had deposited it, Enid glanced at Wednesday with a questioning look.

"Their vegetarian plate did not appeal to me," Wednesday explained without fully meeting her eye, "So I had to settle for this option." She gestured to her plate, now containing only mash potatoes, green beans, and brussel sprouts.

Enid blinked. She could have *sworn* she saw a 'make your own plate' option on the menu…

"Thanks!" she smiled softly at Wednesday. Dark eyes flicked her way for a moment before a small hum of acknowledgment was given.

"Lol," Yoko said aloud with a smirk, "For someone so against love, you sure know the way to someone's heart."

"Of course Iknow how the way to someone' s heart," W ednesday replied, brow still furrowed, "What sort of incompetent medical examiner do you take me for?"

Pugsley laughed so hard he actually started choking on his oversized bite of food. W ednesday casually watched him struggle until Bianca showed mercy and slapped him hard on the back until he could finally breathe again.

"Damn," W ednesday muttered lowly.

"Y eah, thought for sure he was gone that time," Grandmama chuckled.

"Do you have a bet on that too?" Kent asked far too casually .

"W -What?!" Pugsley stuttered through his throat clearing drink of water.

"...Iwill neither confirm nor deny that accusation."

"Kindly refrain from betting on our personal lives," W ednesday demanded.

"No-Im old, Ineed all the entertainment Ican get!"

"Dont be so lazy ."

"Y eah! Go out and cause chaos like everyone else!" Pugsley chimed in.

"It has been a while since Ive been banned from a state," Grandmama mused.

"Y ouve been banned from whole states?" Divina questioned, fork paused midway to her mouth.

"Oh sure! Y ou dont get to be my age without ruffling a few feathers."

"How many states are you banned from?" Yoko asked, leaning forward curiously.

"Well now, that depends on how you count the Dakotas."

"How so?" Bianca chimed in.

"Well technically I've been banned from the Dakotas three times-"

"No you haven't," Wednesday cut in.

"Here we go..." Pugsley sighed.

"Yes I have!" Grandmama snapped, leaning forward to see her granddaughter past Enid, who leaned back to oblige; and also to be less in the middle of whatever was about to happen.

"I got banned back when they were a single territory and then they both banned me again after they became separate states!"

"Didn't- Didn't they become states back in 1889?!" Enid blanched, eyeing the woman who looked like she was only in her late eighties. *What in the world is she?!*

"The initial banishment while they were territories would have been carried over into statehood," Wednesday argued, also leaning forward to meet her grandmother's eye, "Therefore, your so-called second and third bans were nothing more than the Dakotas enforcing a ban already in place. You were only banned once!"

"But the other bans were for different things and made no reference to the first time they banned me!"

"That's probably only because everyone originally involved in your banishment is probably *dead.*"

Sitting between the two bickering Addams— *Addamses?* the two women as they went back and forth, Enid spent a moment contemplating how she got into this situation.

*Or ghtreaetgi hadthi ngssnoul edf omee.*

Seeing that this was clearly a longstanding disagreement if Pugsley's sighs and avoidance of acknowledging what was happening beside him were any indication, the blonde decided to try and add some outside opinions.

"What do you think, Div?" she asked the siren who up until now had been watching the argument like it was a tennis match. "Has Grandmama been banned from the Dakotas once or thrice?"

"Uhhhh," Divina intoned as two dark pairs of eyes snapped towards her and for a moment Enid regretted dragging her into this but she disliked being in the physical middle of an argument. Well, to be honest she disliked being in the middle of any kind of argument, but that was neither here nor there.

"Well- *Technically* speaking you can't be banned from an entire state," the siren eventually spat out.

"What?"

"More likely there's simply a warrant out for your arrest, and thus since you could be arrested by entering that particular state, the banishment' aspect is more of a self-enforced thing."

"So you haven't even been banned at all," Wednesday smirked. Enid half expected her to point a finger at Grandmama and go "Ha!"

"Of course, having said that, it *is* possible to have multiple arrests warrants at once; not to mention statues of limitations causing warrants to expire," Divina shrugged, "So you *can* be banned from a state multiple times; *semantically* at least."

"A-ha!" Grandmama shouted, *actually* pointing her finger at Wednesday and nearly smacking Enid with it in the process.

"She said 'semantically', not literally!"

"Potato, potahto, Dakota wants my head!" the old hag shot back *f a* too gleefully for Enid's liking and the bickering resumed once more.

"Good try ," Pugsley sat up to say to Enid over his sister 's head.

"Thanks?"

"Have you ever been banned from anywhere, Barbie?" Grandmama asked her out of the blue. Enid blanched but the look on the old crone's face seemed sincere; like she *genui nel y* was interested in the answer ~~-in~~ a *posi t e* way, no less ~~th~~ough Enid couldnt understand *hy* .

"Uhhhh," she eloquently replied as she tried to think of an answer .

Her heart ached as she realized she already had one.

"I'm...technically not supposed to be near San Francisco?" Enid answered quietly . Out of the corner of her eye she saw Wednesday perk up in attention to this detail, while her friends all tensed up slightly. Their readiness to step in for her helped to soothe the ache, if only a little.

"Ah, San Fran!" Grandmama cackled, "remember back when that place was just a little ol' boomtown!"

"...how old are you?" Enid heard Bianca whisper hauntingly under her breath.

"That' s quite a feat, getting kicked out of a wild place like that!" Grandmama merrily continued, "What'd ya do?"

"Grandmama-" W ednesday started to intervene before she was cut off.

"She was born into a shit family that didnt appreciate her ."

" *Yoko,"* Enid, Divina, *and* Bianca snapped at once.

"What?" the vampire shrugged, "it's the truth, aint it?"

"Oh? What happen? Were you adopted by a bunch of normies who weren't expecting a werewolf daughter?" the hag asked curiously. "You'd be surprised how often that happens. I swear normies will adopt anything-"

"-I-" Enid started before she stopped and took a moment to compose herself. Talking about home *always* hurt, but this-

"...I would rather not talk about it. Thank you," she eventually managed to work out of her mouth, eyes never lifting from her plate.

An awkward silence fell upon the table.

"What's your favorite type of exercise?" Wednesday asked from so far out of left field Enid couldn't help but look up at her.

"Wha-"

"Exercise," the ravenette repeated, "You're a personal trainer; surely you have a favorite form of working out?"

*She's changing the subject?* Enid thought, stunned for a moment, before her face softened into a grateful smile.

"Well, I'm really fond of calisthenics- ah, that's any exercise that uses just your own body weight and gravity -but weight lifting can be really fun too! I try to use a mix when I'm leading a class, really balance it out, ya know?"

"I see," Wednesday nodded, all of her attention solely on Enid in that moment, "My family is partial to sword fighting; any suggestions for ways to physically improve on that front?"

*I owe you.*

The blonde had to bite her tongue so hard it nearly bled, but she managed to keep her squeak of surprise towards her own thoughts

quiet.

*Damnit Enid, you're fat and out of shape,* she berated herself as out loud she began making suggestions aimed towards leg conditioning and cardio.

*Unbeknownst to Enid, one of her classmates was watching her with rapt attention.*

*Wednesday was* **effortlessly** *graceful in all of her movements. She* **does not** *move like she should just as she does not speak like she should. Her voice is deep and husky, and she has a slight lisp.*

**SHE IS PERFECT.**

"That is an adequate suggestion," Wednesday acknowledged when Enid finally stopped info-dumping, "I will give it a try when we return home."

"Wait- You're actually taking someone else's advice?" Pugsley squealed as his sister casually pinned his hand to the table with her fork.

"Holy shit!" Bianca screeched as she all but launched herself back out of her seat and into Divina next to her.

"Dude!" Kent gaped while Divina just stared slack-jawed at the point of penetration, barely even reacting to Bianca jumping into her personal space.

"*Oh my God.* What is that? B...Positive?" Yoko wondered, sniffing the air.

"Oh, yeah, you're right!" Pugsley grinned.

"Is this really a time for optimism?" Bianca asked, head on a swivel as she and Enid checked to see if any staff members had noticed.

"Pardon me, I find myself needing a new fork. Mine got dirty," Wednesday hummed as she rose from the table.

"Fuck you, I wash my hands!" Pugsley pouted after her as he worked to free himself, surprisingly calm in the face of having his hand

impaled. The rest of the table wound up watching him with quiet morbid fascination.

"Ooookaaaay ," Enid mumbled as she debated whether she should help Pugs pry the *fork* out of the back of his hand, *that* just happened."

"Eh, ya know something, Barbie?" Grandmama chuckled, momentarily distracting Enid from feeling like she might pass out— *boodew* ***not*** *Y— er not at all* what I expected."

"...Whaaat do you mean?"

"Well, I always figured the perfect person for my granddaughter would be some kinda rapscallion," the old hag smiled, "Covered in scars, loaded down with weapons, with vibes that *scream* 'I will kill you if you look at me wrong', but yer as far from that as it gets. Though you did do a good job decking that one clown last night!"

"Um, thanks? Wait- I punched someone?"

"My point is that, honestly , you're the *last* type of person I would expect Wednesday to even *consider* opening herself up to, but damn if ya didn't prove me wrong!" Grandmama cackled, "I've *never* seen her become so comfortable with someone so quickly!"

"Really?" Enid blinked, surprised. Sure, she and Wednesday had been getting along during the day's misadventure, but-

"She's right," Pugsley agreed, finally freed from being attached to the table. Enid blinked dumbly at the back of his hand, which seemed to have already healed itself fully. *Huh, I didn't-*

"Wednesday isn't really ...big on friendships. You must have *really* made a good impression on her last night!"

"Uh, I guess? *I can't remember most of it.*

"A raven and a wolf. An uncommon pairing, but capable of being exceedingly strong, if tended to properly," the hag chuckled softly , before her face grew dead serious.

"Of course if you cause my favorite granddaughter any grief, *I / I / ea*
*yub ggi ngf oe eth l I nee e.*"

"Y e-Yes ma'am," Enid stuttered automatically as she forced herself to not lean away from the old woman's surprisingly heavy glare. t reminded her a little too much of her own mother-

"W a-Wait- What's a raven?"

"A 'raven' is an informal term for a psychic whose visions are primarily negative in nature," W ednesday answered as she retook her seat next to the blonde.

"Oh! Y ou're a psychic?" Enid asked, trying to hide how the smaller woman's sudden and silent reappearance had startled her; nevermind her grandmother's unexpected shovel talk, "That' s sounds neat!"

"I assure you it' s more of an annoyance than anything," W ednesday sighed as she resumed eating. "Just one more thing I inherited unwillingly from my mother."

"I can think of something *el se* you inherited," Pugsley smirked.

"Dont make me retrieve yet another fork, *b the ea* ."

"What' s he mean?" Enid wondered, tilting her head.

"Nothing. Finish your lunch, it' s getting cold."

"A w, she cares!"

"I will leave your corpse in the desert for the vultures to feed upon, Pugsley, *so el pm e*-"

"Could you two try to *not* get us thrown out!?

# Chapter 5

Chapter Notes

No, Iam not dead
Yes, I *di d*change the chapter count. ~~*g*~~*a**i**n.*
~~No, Iwill not apologiz~~*e* ~~—~~ That is a bald faced lie, Iam sorry , the brain rot drives the writing.

Bit of a boring chapter but Ihope you like it anyway~

They were waiting on the waitress to return with their cards and change ~~–~~after finally convincing Grandmama to *not* dine-and-dash ~~w~~hen Y oko's phone went off. She glanced at the screen and immediately started cursing.

"*F**k,* our spa appointment!"

"Oh shit,"Divina blinked, "completely forgot about that."

"W ell to be fair it's been an eventful morning,"Bianca drawled while finishing off the last of her drink.

"Oh? Why' s that"?Kent asked, cocking his head, "Did something happen"?

"...Y ou. *You* happened, *K**nt*"

"Oh riigghhht;the ~~h~~angover parody . *E**h*- My bad"?

"f we leave now we should be able to still make it,"Divina assured Yoko as she stood up from the table.

Enid went to stand up as well, when she heard a long drawn out sigh coming from beside her. A glance proved that Wednesday now had a minor scowl on her face and it took the blonde an embarrassingly long moment to remember why.

*Right, back to the hunt*

"You guys go on ahead-" Enid told her party before even bothering to think twice about it, "I'll catch up with you later."

"Uh?"

"What?"

"But- it's a *spa day*! You *love* spa days!" Yoko spluttered.

"Yeah, even Kent is joining us."

"I like how they do my nails!"

"I'll join next time," the blonde assured them with a smile, "But I promised Wens she and I would *do something*." Enid looked at her friends pointedly.

"Do- *Oh*!" Yoko blinked owlishly, "Right, right! That thing, that you were gonna do before this whole nonsense came up," she waved her hand in Kent's general direction.

"Hm? What thing?" Grandmama asked.

*Eh, Wednesday doesn't mean much to her, but I know she'll be happy to hear it.*

"Uhhh-" Enid uttered uselessly before the ravenette in question jumped in.

"We're going off to engage in more sexual activities."

"*Wednesday*!" the blonde squeaked; throwing the woman a very blush-filled 'what is wrong with you?' look, while Grandmama merely started cackling. Enid blanched when she noticed that their waitress had returned at exactly the wrong time, but if she'd heard anything she kept it to herself; opting instead to leave their items on the table and wish them all a good day before she left.

"*Aw,* caught the love-bug, huh?" she toothily grinned, "Cant say that Iblame ya;you are your parents' kid after all."

Wednesday glared lightly at the old hag but otherwise held her tongue.

"W ell Iwont keep ya then," Grandmama said, rising from her seat, leaving her share of change on the table. "Pugsley , be a good boy and show me where the hell our hotel is!"

"Kay!"

Good-byes' and See ya laters' were passed around as they all exited the restaurant—Grandmama and Pugsley starting to mosey down the street while the bachelorette party opted to take a conveniently passing taxi ~~un~~til only Enid and W ednesday remained, standing shoulder to shoulder on the sidewalk.

"I apologize for the sacrifice of your spa day," W ednesday stated once everyone had left.

"It' s fine," Enid waved of f with a smile. "W e already have another planned right before the actual wedding. Besides, this is just *a bi t e* more pressing." She held up her forefinger and thumb pinched close together. "And thanks. For helping us find Kent."

"It was also slightly more pressing," W ednesday admitted with a small shrug. "Shall we return to the Korean barbecue?"

"Exactly what Iwas thinking," the blonde nodded. As one they began retracing their steps, once again seamlessly falling in line with each other's pace like they had been doing it for years.

They made it a block before Enid remembered something.

"By the way;why the *f uk* is your go-to distraction answer us having sex?" she asked, still mildly mif fed at *tha* particular part of the conversation.

"It is not my 'go-to' it simply worked well enough the first time she asked—while also being the truth and proved to be just as effective the second time when you seemed to be flailing for any answer that wasn't 'we're looking for where we *all eged ly* got married last night.'"

"...Okay , *f air,* but still! You couldn't have thought of anything else to say?!"

"Not at that moment, no. At least not anything she would have as readily believed."

As Enid grumbled her reluctant admittance—she hadn't come up with any alternative in the moment either—Wednesday worked her jaw for a few moments before she spoke once again.

"My grandmother made you uncomfortable talking about San Franscisco. This was not my fault, but... I apologize on her behalf."

"It's okay," the blonde sighed. "It's just a...bit of a sore subject, is all."

Wednesday hummed her acknowledgment and they continued to walk down the sidewalk in a silence that was not quite as uncomfortable as it could have been. The afternoon sun continued to beat down upon them, people passed them by in either direction, and the world carried on carrying on.

"...Most werewolves wolf out in their tweens," Enid said softly after nearly a block, "it's basically another part of puberty."

Wednesday's head snapped towards her, eyes wide.

"Enid, you don't have to-"

"I know ," the blonde cut her off, smiling gently but sadly at the ground in front of their still moving feet. "I know I don't have to. It's actually kind of funny; I hate, and I mean *hate,* talking about this.

*Er* . t always hurts, no matter how long it' s been.But... Iwanna tell you anyway."

She turned her eyes towards Wednesday, still smiling that same damned sad smile, and the ravenette couldnt find it in her to refuse the silent reqest to listen to her tale. She nodded, once, and Enid continued.

"All of my brothers- Ihave four -had no trouble wolfing out. Becoming big and strong and *f ury* . Im the youngest and Icouldnt *wat* for my turn;to wolf out and *f i nal* join the rest of my family and pack during the full moon. Every single moon Iwould join them in our pack' s territory, just *wat ng* for that feeling to finally wash over me."She paused to swallow and Wednesday felt the urge to once again tell her she did not have to do this.

She bit her tongue instead and focused on listening.

"My tenth and eleventh birthdays rolled by without anything happening, but we hadnt been too worried. Before me Collin had been the latest at almost twelve but that's still pretty normal. Plenty of other werewolves dont get their fur until theyre thirteen or even a little older!Nothing wrong with being a late bloomer!"Enid tried to inject some cheer into her voice, but it didnt quite take.

"I turned twelve. And then thirteen. But moon after moon nothing changed. *I* didnt change. W e started to worry when Iwas fourteen. Started scheduling appointments with every specialist in town. Then the state. Then the country. My parents even sent me to camps for a few summers. We tried *eve hi ng* to make me wolf out.

"Nothing worked..."

Enid paused, for several long moments, and Wednesday took the opportunity to speak.

"That sounds like it was...very dif ficult,"she said, with as much tact as she could muster. "H wever , Ifeel Iam missing something

relevant;what does your inability to 'wolf out' have to do with you being disowned by your family?A family that clearly cared for you since they went to such lengths?"

Enid chuckled, but it was a dark and bitter sound;one that Wednesday instantly hated hearing coming from the usually joyful blonde.

"Y ou dont get it. A werewolf who cant wolf out is seen as *weak.* A detriment to the pack,"the blonde explained, the words sounding like something recited to her countless times. "Our duty is to find a strong mate and continue the pack's legacy;to make it stronger . Any and all weaknesses are to be dealt with. No exceptions."

Wednesday felt a pit form in her stomach as her mind came up with only one conclusion. "Y ou dont mean-"

Enid smiled that same *damn* sad smile at the ravenette. "...My parents held off the council for as long as they could;gave them every excuse they could think of to stall. To buy me more time to wolf out."She shrugged, "t didnt matter . Iturned eighteen and by pack law officially deemed unfit to be a member. Dad made sure my final year at Nevermore was paid for, but... Iwas declared a lone wolf before Ieven graduated."

"A lone wolf?"

"Means Im basically banned from every other pack. Ever ,"the blonde explained, "Not that any pack would *willingly* take in a wolf who couldnt transform anyway ."She cleared her throat, looking skyward as she wiped at the corners of her eyes.

"So, yeah, that' s, uh, that's why Im not really allowed to be near San Francisco;it' s a bit too close to pack land for my taste. Though Istill miss the tacos,"she finished, looking back at W ednesday and forcing her smile to be more grin-like.

The grin faded when she saw how tense the shorter woman walking next to her had become. How her jaw was clenched hard enough that it made her cheeks all the sharper looking. How her fists were squeezed so tightly that Enid half feared her knuckle bones would pierce clear through her own skin. How every single muscle in the woman's body seemed to radiate with *rage.*

Enid would have been worried, if she wasn't busy trying to calm down her racing heart and tell her mind that yelling how hot the ravenette looked at that moment was not helpful in the slightest.

She wasn't super successful.

---

Wednesday Addams was *livid.*

The sheer *audacity* of those who claimed to be Enid's kin! Discarding her for simply being the way she is; for not being exactly the same as every one else. Who in the name of *hell* did they think they were?!

To make matters worse- What *really* got under her skin -was that she understood the notion. Wednesday could *clearly* see the logic behind such a decision. She herself used a similar principle as a child when raising her thoroughbred spiders: keep the strong ones; the ones with the most vibrant of markings; the most lethal of venom; and cull the rest.

However the mere *idea* of someone doing the same thing to Enid was- it was- They- Wednesday growled, pausing long enough on the sidewalk to stamp her foot; the embarrassment of acting like a petulant child only adding to her already unsettled emotions.

"What right do they have to decide whether or not you would make an acceptable pack member?!" she ground out after *finally* finding the words to convey her displeasure. "Pruning the family tree of weak branches is one thing, but they could have at the very least let you die in the attempt to prove yourself!"

"Say what now?!" Enid squeaked.

"I've tried to kill Pugsley on average of once a day since his *birth!*" Wednesday continued, heedless of the blonde, "Same with Pubert! And any of my attempts succeeded it would have been a sign that they simply were not strong enough to be an Addams!" The ravenette stomped her foot again. "But *this!* Tossing you out simply because you did not meet their standards? Without giving you a *chance* to prove your worth in other ways?! How could- Why should- *Evil!* Unacceptable!"

She stalked down the sidewalk, her anger-her *rage* at-Enid's circumstance coupled with her unexpected struggle with her words creating an aura of *death* that caused every other body on the sidewalk to give the ravenette an ever widening berth.

Save for the blonde who simply carried on walking beside her; if only a bit slack-jawed at what words she did manage to spit out.

"As if a- How did you put it? A non-wolfed out' werewolf has no value in and of themselves! You still have claws! Your senses are *clearly* superior to that of a normie! Is your strength greater as well? *There!* You see! You already have some amount of value!" she snapped when Enid nodded an affirmative. Wednesday blinked as another blood-boiling thought occurred to her.

"You said that werewolves don't typically transform until puberty, yes?"

"Ye-Yeah?"

"Than that means that every full moon-when I presume every post-pubescent werewolf has to change? The vast majority of the adults will be far too busy- busy *pimping* in the woods to properly watch the smaller spawn!"

"Spawn?"

"Would you *not* then be the *perfect* candidate to watch the little miscreants while their parents are unable to?" Would that not be a boon to the pack?" Wednesday was so incensed by this oversight she even went as far as to *actually* curl her raised fingers into a pair of air quotes; Enid wisely—knowingly or otherwise—did not comment on this particular gesture.

"If *I* could come up with a solution within two minutes, what *possible* excuse could your ragged, mangy, unkempt *horde* of pack have?" she growled. "As far as I can tell, their own stupidity cost them a perfectly good pack member and it is *their* loss, not yours. Good riddance!"

*Not good enough though,* she thought darkly. *Did not enough they would dress a dear one for simply not fitting in with their dear fake pet dog, but do it to* ***Enid*** *of all people—*

Enid, who could be quick and clever.

Enid, who clearly had a higher than average amount of loyalty towards those she cared for.

Enid, who still managed to speak so kindly to *everyone* in spite of her circumstances, but still had enough of a spine to stand up to the likes of *Wednesday*.

"Where exactly in San Francisco did you say your former pack resides?" she asked, coming to a stop to directly address Enid, her mind already whirring with plans of retribution.

Wild fires were always breaking out in California, were they not?

Enid stopped, her head turned to look at Wednesday, jaw slightly agape. To the shorter woman's confusion the blonde's eyes became lined with, as of yet, unshed tears at the same time that her mouth spread into a warm and genuine smile.

"Thank you," Enid said firmly.

Wednesday cocked her head. "...Ihave done nothing yet."

"I know- And for the record Idont want you to," she laughed, wiping at her eyes. Wednesday's fingers twitched with an unexpected urge to assist her. "I've seen what you do to your *brother*. Moon knows what you would do to people you *really* dont like!"

"A fair assumption. But why thank me now?"

"Just... Thank you," Enid smiled;blindly bright even under the Nevada sun, "For ...understanding, I guess?"

Wednesday thought that was an odd thing to be thankful for— *for something that should have been obvious to anyone with a brain*— but quietly said "You're welcome" nonetheless.

---

The Korean barbecue was within sight when Enid tensed up in the middle of a conversation they had been having concerning the field dressing of various animals. Apparently Enid's father had made a point of personally teaching all of his children the finer points of the art, and Wednesday was happily as much as she was willing to show comparing and contrasting their technique versus the traditional 'Addams method'.

"Holy W ens," she started, eyes fixed dead ahead, "Do you remember how we got into a little fight with some clowns last night?"

"Vaguely, thanks to Grandmama's 'moonshadow'. Why?"

"Two of them are walking right behind us and are talking about some very not nice things that they want to do to us."

As casually as she could, Wednesday turned her head just enough to glance at the sidewalk behind them. There were a fair number of people using this particular stretch of sidewalk, but one specific pair of them stuck out like a severed thumb in a cocktail glass. Two men, both of Korean descent, were walking a few yards away;heads bent

together and blatantly gesturing towards them. They were so engrossed in each other that they neither noticed Wednesday and several times nearly walked into other people as they walked.

*Aha us,* she thought dourly, *I eat try to pretend you are not being suspicious.*

The men were speaking loud enough for even Wednesday's ears to catch them, but the words themselves held no meaning for her; spoken in what she eventually presumed was some Korean dialect.

"You can understand them?" she asked Enid, returning her eyes to the way ahead of them; the restaurant was fast coming up on their right. "I did not realize you spoke Korean."

"I don't *speak it* super well," Enid argued, also pointedly looking ahead. "My accent sucks; I just understand it enough to know that these guys are gonna be trouble if they catch up to us."

"Hm. Agreed; with so many people around an altercation has a high probability of involving the local authorities, and we've been delayed enough as is."

"Not exactly what I meant, but I'll take it," Enid huffed a laugh. "Any ideas?"

"I do, in fact," Wednesday stated quietly as they paused at the last intersection between them and the Korean barbecue, the crosswalk sign blazing red as vehicles rolled by. A sly glance revealed the men had stopped as well; they at least had enough sense to keep a few people between themselves, Enid and her.

"Do you recall how we lost them last night?"

A grin spread across Enid's face. "As a matter of fact, I do! And since our drunk-as-skunks selves could do it-"

"Then we should have even less of a problem in our current states," the ravenette nodded, the faintest twitch at the corner of her mouth matching the spark in her eyes.

"Go when the traf fic slows?" the blonde asked under her breath, nodding at the busy street before them as she raised both arms above her head in a languid stretch.

"My thoughts exactly ," Wednesday replied, forcing her eyes away from the sliver of stomach that appeared when her shirt rode up slightly.

"Gotcha."

As traffic light turned yellow and the cars began to come to a stop in front of them, the girls took off;sprinting across the road in tandem. Twin shocked male voices called out behind them, the spattering of voices piping up afterwards suggesting they were shoving their way through the crowd.

Enid and Wednesday dashed past the front of the restaurant before taking a sharp turn into the alley right next to it. It was a long alley , but the tall chain link fence at the end of it was still plain to see. With a burst of speed the blonde pulled ahead, reaching the fence first and all but jumping straight up to the top of it. Swinging over a leg, she straddled the top and leaned back down, holding her hand out for Wednesday.

Wednesday heard the men yelling behind her when she reached the fence, moving upwards in something between a jump and a scramble. Enid latched onto her hand, pulling her up so quickly that Wednesday nearly cleared the fence altogether. Their feet touched back down onto the concrete just as the men slammed into the fence behind them.

"YOU FUCKING BITCHES!" one with a black-eye yelled while he and his friend tried to clamber up the chain link.

"*Oh!* I think I did that," Enid winced as she and Wednesday took off down the sidewalk, yelling back, "Sorry about your eye!"

"GET BACK HERE!"

Wednesday felt a pleased smirk slide onto her face, bolstered by the sound of breathy puffs of laughter from beside her. The pair made their way down the street, taking the next right turn and then the left ~~-g~~aining the ire of several drivers when they dashed across the road ~~wi~~th only the barest indication from either of them to suggest where to turn. Ducking into the next recessed doorway they came upon, Enid yanked open the door, ushering Wednesday in and carefully closing it behind her.

Moving to the window, the pair crouched behind a large potted plant, and waited. After a tense few seconds, two male figures passed by; but on the far side of the street. Watching them disappear from view, Enid and Wednesday released their held breath in time with each other. Straightening up, the pair looked at each other before breaking out into quiet giggles for Enid and huffs of amusement from Wednesday.

"I can not believe that worked twice."

"*I* can't believe we pulled that off when we were *drunk!*"

"Indeed," the ravenette remarked, "Almost as surprising as you understanding Korean."

"*Yeah.* I used to be a K-Pop-stan- well, I kinda still am? Just not quite as...*intensely*," Enid chuckled, hand rising to scratch at one cheek. "Anyway I wanted to know what the lyrics meant, so I looked it up; then I started like, googling South Korea in general; and *then* I got into K-dramas too and, just, kinda picked it up?"

"You incidentally learned to speak an entire language?" Wednesday asked, brow rising.

"Not an *ent re* language," Enid argued, "There are still some phrases I struggle with."

"Interesting." *Very interesting,* Wednesday thought, gazing up at the blonde. Enid met her eyes for a moment, before a gentle blush bloomed on her face and she looked away. The ravenette watched as her eyes focused on something beside them, the blonde's eyes widening in surprise.

"Wens! Look!"

Wednesday turned, taking note of a glass counter high display case. Shelved within it were rows upon rows of gleaming rings. There had to have been a hundred of them in there, but she knew *exactly* which one Enid was looking at.

There, sitting plain as day in the middle of similar stoneless rings, was a dead match for the ones they had woken up with just that very morning.

Wednesday and Enid looked at each other.

They had found the chapel.

# Chapter 6

Chapter Notes

> Yes, Iknow it's been two years.
> Yes, the chapter count has gone up for what Ihope will be the last time.
> Yes, you ARE an absolute saint for waiting this long and Ithank you sincerely for your patience.
> Enjoy over 6,000 words of the girls getting into further shenanigans!
>
> Shout out to cryptoboobology on discord for realizing Iwas this fic's author and lovingly bullying me to finally finishing this damn thing

See the end of the chapter for more notes

“W ens, we found it!” Enid grinned, squealing as the pair looked further around the room.

The assault on her eardrums aside, Wednesday had to agree with the blonde’s assessment as the more of their surroundings she took in the clearer her hazy memories from last night became.

She *remembered* this place.

The room they were in appeared to be the reception area; specifically of the business variety, not the traditional after-wedding celebration. There were large windows on either side of the door they had snuck in from, each stenciled with the words “Chase Y our Heart Chapel” in fanciful script and “ wedding services” spaced out in all caps underneath. Wednesday and Enid currently stood to the right of the front door, with the plant they’d hidden behind, the jewelry case, a couch, an armchair, and a low coffee table. The side farthest from them held a small bookshelf, another glass counter with even more wedding paraphernalia inside of it, and a computer on top.

Along the back wall were two doorways; a set of faux-ornate double-doors right in the in the very middle of the wall, presumably leading to the chapel proper and one behind the reception counter with a simple sign that read, "employees only."

The white walls were decorated with legal certificates, options for wedding officiants, among which were two *different* Elvis impersonators to chose from, for some reason and photos of "satisfied customers." The decor gave the impression of being an Abrahamic-esque church that had been assaulted by a drunk Cupid, but looking carefully revealed that in a past life it had been some kind of store; indents from racks still visible through the once-fresh coat of paint.

Wednesday was about to ask Enid if she thought the plural of Elvis should be "Elvises" or "Elvi," her personal preference when she caught the blonde perking up.

Before she could make any sort of inquiry, the employee door opened and a brunette woman about their age stepped out. She was dressed in a cream-colored button up shirt, and burgundy vest, black slacks, and a thinly striped tie. A gold colored nametag proclaimed her name to be "Phoebe A." She looked more like a theater usher than someone involved in wedding ceremonies, but Wednesday wasn't versed enough in the world of "holy matrimony" to be sure.

"Apologies if you were waiting long," she said, closing the door behind her as she took what seemed to be her usual position behind the front counter, customer service smile fully in place. "Hard to hear things from the back office sometimes. I'm Phoebe; how may I help you two today?"

"Good afternoon, Phoebe," Enid chirped, bouncing over to the woman's counter in barely restrained glee. Wednesday followed at a more sedated manner; quietly pleased the more sociable of the two of them was happy to take point in making conversation.

"We're pretty sure we got married here late last night-" the blonde explained, "and we were wondering if you still had the paperwork here saying so?"

"We usually send in all necessary paperwork every few days, so it is entirely possible it's still in the office's outgoing bin," the employee answered readily enough, though the psychic noted her smile seem a hair more strained than before.

"Great! We were wondering— and I'm sure you hear this a *lot*—but we were wondering if it was possible for you to *not* send it in?"

"I'm afraid Chase Your Heart Chapel doesn't do refunds."

"Oh no, we don't want a refund!" Enid swore, flapping her hand in front of her face, "I actually don't know how much we even spent last night."

"A frivolous amount no doubt," Wednesday drolled.

"What makes you say that?" the blonde asked, head turning her way.

"Frivolous events undoubtedly involve frivolous amounts of money."

"...I'm choosing to interpret that as 'no amount is too much in order to bind my love to me forever' rather than you mocking romance again."

Wednesday felt her lip twinge into half a sneer, "Please do not twist my words."

"Too late," she chirped before returning her gaze to the woman, "Anyway, we were hoping if, maybe, we could convince you to *not* file our paperwork?"

The woman sighed, shoulders slipping slightly while her smile slid all the way off her face.

"Let me guess: you realized that not only was your marriage a mistake but *also* that it takes six weeks of residing in Nevada before you're eligible to divorce," she stated, customer service smile fully replaced with a far more realistic bored expression, "But you're *tourists* and neither of you can and/or want to move here for a month and a half and you want *me* to get your paperwork and hand it over so that legally it looks like the marriage never happened in the first place. Does that about sum it up?"

Enid blinked. "Uh- Yeah! Spot on, actually."

"Hundred bucks."

"Wha- *Excuse* me?!"

"You want me to do this very much illegal thing? It will cost you one hundred dollars."

"That's-"

"Fifty dollars," Wednesday stated.

"Wens?" she squeaked, head snapping her way once more.

"Ninety," Phoebe shot back without skipping a beat.

"Sixty."

"Eighty."

"Sixty-five."

"*Seventy-five*, and that's my final offer!"

"...Agreed."

"*Wednesday*."

"You have to admit it's a respectable hustle," Wednesday said, handing over the necessary bills. The woman accepted the cash, folding and tucking them neatly into her pocket before grabbing a pen and a stack of sticky notes while Enid quietly grumbled her disagreement.

"Names?" she asked, peeling off a sticky note.

After giving both of their names and spelling them out ~~"~~Yes of course I mean two d's in Addams; the most common spelling of Wednesday already has two d's and so pointing that out is redundant." ~~the~~ woman told them to wait as she left back through the employees only door.

Enid blew out a puff of air after a long moment of silence.

"So; this is it, huh? No more being married."

"Indeed."

"Well just be two tourists in Las Vegas who just happened to meet."

"I am rather impressed that the old adage of Las Vegas and things remaining here bears some truth after all."

"Yup," Enid nodded slowly.

The moment stretched out into a minute which further lengthened to several more as for the first time since either of them woke up that morning, Wednesday and Enid found themselves standing silently and ~~awkwardly~~ in each other's presence.

The blonde had just opened her mouth ~~a~~ and Wednesday's focus had abruptly snapped towards her ~~wh~~ when she just as quickly closed it right before the door opened once more and Phoebe returned.

"Sorry girls; no dice."

"Pardon?"

"What?"

"We don't have your marriage certificate," Phoebe shrugged.

"What do you *mean* you don't have our certificate?!" Enid all but shrieked.

Phoebe rolled her eyes, *"look* we married four couples yesterday and none of them were an Enid, Wednesday, Addams, Sinclair, or any combination thereof."

"Wha- But-" Enid spluttered before breaking off into a small growl.

Wednesday felt her heart twitch slightly at the sound and she gave it a mental kick followed by several threats to control itself or else.

"Okay, *fine*. Can we at least have our money back?"

"Nope."

"What do you mean *nope*?"

"Looking for your paper was still illegal even if I didn't find it," Phoebe shrugged again, crossing her arms, "No refunds."

"B-But-"

"No. *Refunds.*"

"We understand," Wednesday acknowledged with a nod, "Have a nice day. Come along, Enid."

Enid looked like she wished to continue arguing, but chose to quietly follow Wednesday outside instead; only speaking up once the door closed behind them with a jingle of its bell.

"What are you up to, Wens?" she asked as they walked a few steps down the sidewalk. When the counter inside disappeared from their view, Wednesday stopped and turned to face the blonde.

"I require you to distract her ."

"Distrac- Who? *Her?*"

"Y es."

"Okay . *Why?*"

"Because basic fire code regulation insists that all businesses must have more than one point of entry, even if only as a oneway exit, and Iam sure this business is no dif ferent."

"Entry- So, what;you're going to *sneak in the* e and make sure she's telling the truth?Y ou think she's lying?"

"I is not entirely out of the realm of possibility that a business such as this allows overly intoxicated people to get married so that in order for them to get divorced the city becomes home to at least one more foolhardy sucker to spend their money here for six additional weeks,"W ednesday explained, quietly amazed at how patient she felt at the moment, "Or , more likely, she simply didn't look very hard and appreciated easy cash."

"Or *maybe* this just isn't the chapel we're looking for?"Enid suggested, one brow raised.

"That is also a possibility , but Iwould like to see for myself to be sure."

"...Y ou're going to break in whether Idistract her or not, aren't you."

"Y es, but my chances of escape would increase significantly if you keep her occupied up front."

Enid sighed. "How long?"

"T en minutes should suffice. Perhaps fifteen, if you can manage."

The blonde scratched at one brow, looking less than enthusiastic over the entire endeavor.

"...This is a terrible idea, but it *would* be nice to be sure," she eventually acquiesced with another sigh, "*Fine.* I'll see what I can do."

"I trust in your social abilities."

Enid gave a warm smile, "Thanks, Wens. Good luck."

Wednesday gave a single nod before spinning on her heel and marching down the sidewalk, turning right out of sight at the first alleyway she came to.

She blamed the Nevada sun for the sudden warming of her cheeks and ears.

---

"'Distract her' she says," Enid grumbled, dragging one hand halfway down her face, "After she just watched us walk out of her business and knows *damn well* we have no reason to walk back in. Yeah. Sure. No problem."

She closed her eyes and let a low growl rumble in the base of her throat as her fingers tapped cascadingly across her cheek. Enid stood on the sidewalk for a long moment before her eyes flicked open and her hand pulled far enough from her face for her to stare down at it.

Specifically at the base of one finger in particular.

Wiping off the absolutely *feral* grin that had then bloomed on her face as her idea struck, Enid schooled her expression into something more politely neutral as she turned and made her way back to the chapel's front door.

Phoebe looked up from her phone and lightly scowled at her as the door's overhead bell jingled her arrival.

"The answer is still no."

"Yeah no, Ifully got that!Iactually had a *different* question for you. See the reason we thought this was the right chapel in the first place is because we both woke up this morning wearing matching rings and saw the exact same kind of rings in your case over there," Enid explained with a half-bashful-looking smile, hooking her thumb towards the display in question.

"Okay? And?"

"Is there any chance you could tell me where you got those rings from?" she asked as sweetly as she could, "It might help us narrow down where we might have gone last night if it wasnt here."

Phoebe tapped one nail slowly against the counter several times before sagging with a sigh.

"Yeah, okay," she said as she rounded the counter and made her way across the room, "Guess it's not illegal to talk about jewelry. Which rings do you have?"

*Oh a* Enid grinned internally, patting her mental self on the back as she joined Phoebe by the case.

"We have two of these right here," she said, pointing to the row of braided rings.

"Well at least you two have good taste in rings," Phoebe nodded sagely, "Those silver and gold bands come from a local distributor. Best handcrafted rings in the county. Iguess Icould give you his number."

"Oh thank you *somuch!* That'd be- ...Wait, they're silver? Really?"

"Yup. Genuine Sterling."

“...Are you *sure?*

“Yes, I’m sure,” Phoebe stated flatly. Enid held her hands up placatingly.

“*Okay*, it’s just- I’m allergic to silver, and even after wearing the ring for hours I didn’t have a mark on me.”

“You’re allergic? To *silver?*

Enid rolled her eyes—*typical* ~~an~~ and debated flicking out her claws to prove it like she had with Wednesday, when she had a better idea.

Well; better for *distraction* purposes, at least.

“Yup!” she chirped, “I can prove it too, if you have something that you know for one hundred percent certain is real silver. Something *besides* the rings here.”

The other woman’s face visually debated on the suggestion for a few seconds before she shrugged and reached for her own neck. Digging under the collar of her shirt, she pulled a long silvery chain over her head, tugging it out from under her shirt until the entirety of it popped loose. She held the necklace out towards Enid, at the end of which swung an adorable thimble-sized charm in the shape of a sheep; the finer details of the head and coat were darkened by the distinct color of lightly tarnished silver.

*Real* silver.

“Alright silver girl,” she drawled, “Prove it.”

*Oh Wednesday* ***soo much for*** *this.*

Taking a deep breath, Enid reached out and wrapped her left hand around the silver-colored bauble. She held on for one, two, three seconds before rapidly releasing it with a small hiss.

Holding her hand palm up between them, Enid showed Phoebe the mark her charm had left behind on her skin;an exact duplicate of one side of her sheep down to the artistic whorls of its wool coat pressed into her palm and the pads of two fingers.

Enid thought she caught of whiff of her own singed flesh and forcefully told herself it was her imagination exaggerating;her skin wasn't even blistering. Just, now a rather angry shade of red.

"Oh *shit*!" Phoebe gasped, pulling her necklace farther away from Enid, "You weren't kidding!"

"Nope. Now , can you pass me one of those rings?"

"A-Are you sure?That doesn't look fun."

"Oh it' s not as bad as it looks!Think of a mild sunburn. I'll be fine eventually."

Phoebe didn't look wholly convinced, but still gamely pulled a keyring out of her pocket and unlocked the case. Distantly Enid thought she heard a door opening and closing somewhere in the building and silently hoped no other employees were on site.

Sliding the entire box out, Phoebe placed it on top of the display and gestured for Enid to try her hand;literally .

Acting with more bravado than she actually felt, Enid reached out and pinched the braided ring that was closest to her between her thumb and forefinger. Letting out a small sigh of relief when nothing happened, she pulled the ring free from the velvet and slipped it onto her finger, holding it up for Phoebe.

"See?Not silver . Or at least not more than fifty percent. Doesn't even feel warm to me."

The relief on Phoebe's face at Enid's skin *not* becoming inflamed before her eyes very swiftly shifted to outrage as she sneered at the

box of rings.

"Oh that *f ucker!* He charged us top dollar for those rings!" she snapped, letting out a decent growl for a normie.

"Have you guys bought a lot of stuff from him before?" Enid asked, her curiosity getting the better of her while she tugged the ring off and replaced it in the box.

"Yeah like, almost half our stock!"

"*Oof.*"

There were six display boxes full of rings, each holding nearly a hundred rings in ten neat rows. And if these were just the ones they had on *display* and more were stored elsewhere, that meant a pretty penny had been spent no matter how one sliced it.

"*Ugh-* My boss is gonna *flip* when he finds out; how many crappy rings has he sold us?"

"I could help you find out, if you'd like," Enid offered before she could properly think it through. Though even after she *did* think it through, it still seemed like a "good idea," but only for the sake of the ongoing task of distracting.

*Better than thinking about Steven.* ***At least!***

"Help?" Phoebe asked, brow raised, "How?"

"*Well*, it'd make it a lot easier to yell at this guy if you could confidently say which rings aren't the alleged grade of silver, right?"

"Well, *yeah.* But what; you want to just jab all of our rings into you and see which ones *burn?*"

"Not *all* of them!" Enid shrugged with more nonchalance than she actually felt, "Gold does nothing to me, and I think it's safe to assume

duplicates of the same style of ring will probably be similar in quality; higher grades would stick out too much otherwise."

"That's still *a lot* of rings to test," Phoebe said, gesturing towards the five ring boxes still sitting in the display case and the one she'd placed on top. "Won't that hurt? Like, *a lot*?"

"Naaaaah—just a quick sting; the pain only *really* gets bad if it's held there too long. A quick tap should be enough. Less than second, I swear," she assured her, *saving* quite a blue streak in her head for having the idea in the first place.

"...And you're *willing* to help me with this?"

"Absolutely."

Phoebe glared at her for a long moment before she sagged.

"Okay."

"*Great!* My services cost seventy-five dollars; cash," Enid chirped, holding her none burned palm up towards the woman, biting her tongue when Phoebe's jaw *dropped.*

"*What!* I- *You*- Why-"

Enid did her very best to keep her smile under control as the woman's face traveled through several different emotions before settling on resignation and what Enid thought might have even been respect. Phoebe reached into her pocket and pulled out the bills Wednesday had handed over earlier, placing it gently but firmly into Enid's hand.

"Well played, blondie. Well played."

---

Ten minutes, several hundred rings, and fifty-some new mild burns to her left arm later, Enid and Phoebe's little examination session came

to an end when a knock sounded against the window nearest to them.

Looking up and making eye contact with Wednesday standing outside on the sidewalk, Enid breathed a quiet sigh of relief.

"Sorry , Pheebs, that's my cue to bounce."

"Y eah, that's fine. Honestly Ithink we probably could have stopped a while ago," Phoebe said, wincing as she looked at the pile of bad rings' that had accumulated on top of the case.

"No harm in being thorough," Enid grinned, already backing up towards the door.

"*Eh,* tell that to your arm, blondie," she chuckled lowly before waving with a genuine smile, "Have a good one, Enid; hope you two figure out the marriage thing."

"Thanks! Bye Phoebe!" Enid waved back before opening the door and meeting Wednesday outside. She walked casually by the ravenette, who easily fell in step beside her, and waited until they were out of sight of the windows before she spoke.

"So how'd it go? Did you find our papers?"

Wednesday opened her mouth to reply, only for to it snap shut again with an audible click as her eye got caught on Enid's arm.

"What happened?" she demanded, literally pulling Enid to a stop by grabbing her left hand and lifting it upwards for a better view of her skin.

"I distracted her by testing the silver quality of the shop' s rings."

"Why!?"

"Because she claimed the kind we woke up with were made with silver, and I said, 'yeah, no' and demonstrated my allergy-" Enid

explained, twisting her left hand in the ravenettte's surprisingly gentle grip to show the sheep-burn on her palm, "and then Iof fered to check the rest of the silver colored rings so she could point out to her boss which ones-"

"Imean *why* would you allow yourself to be injured in this fashion?"

"Y ou said to distract her!Besides they're not *that* bad;there' s just...a lot of them, that's all."

And it was true. While her left arm now had several rows worth of centimeter long thin oblongs, each one on its own was merely a pale red that rose slightly on Enid's skin;it was just that having the same kind of mark multiplied the length of her forearm gave the effect that she had leaned against a hot piece of diamond plated steel. Thankfully *only* her arm was injured, as she and Phoebe had developed the system of the other woman handling the rings for the tests to spare Enid's fingers.

"...Are you in pain?W ednesday asked in a quiet voice.

"Not really . Like Isaid, it' s not as bad as it looks."

Wednesday did not look convinced;her left hand still holding Enid' s while the other hovered right above her skin, tracing the air over each mark.

"...f it makes you feel any better , Ihave a bottle of aloe vera back in my room thatll help speed my healing up?I really isnt that much different from a sunburn."

Wednesday stared at her arm for one more long moment before nodding.

"Y es, that sounds like a fair course of action,"she said, slowly letting go of her hand. She looked up at Enid before turning away and beginning to march down the sidewalk. "And while we are there we can also check on the status of your device."

"Oh yeah;Iforgot about that,"Enid admitted, easily catching up to the ravenette, "Y oure right, it should be charged by now ."

They made it half a block before Enid's brow furrowed.

"W ait;what do we need my phone for?"

Wednesday sighed. "Because unfortunately , that woman had been correct."

"*What?*"

"Isearched all of the documents in the conveniently placed outgoing bin, along with the ones near it, and found nothing that was of concern to either of us;we were not married in that chapel."

"*Aww,*" Enid whined, drooping even as she continued to match Wednesday's determined pace, "That means Igot burned for nothing. *Darn.*"

"...ndeed,"W ednesday said lowly, glancing at the blonde's arm once more. "...My apologies;Ishould have trusted in my own abilities more rather than ask you to assist."

"t' s fine;dont worry about it. Better that we know for sure, right?" Enid assured her with a smile.

Wednesday hummed an acknowledgment, but didnt say a word for the rest of the walk back to Enid's hotel.

---

Wednesday insisted on applying the aloe vera herself and Enid didnt put up much of a fight on the matter . Using her free hand she scrolled through the gallery of her now fully charged phone while the ravenette diligently applied the ointment to each individual burn mark.

*Dadas i ndeed,* Enid thought with a small smile.

"T old you Itake a lot of pics," she said out loud, holding the phone so Wednesday could see the screen if she wished. She flicked through photo after photo from last night: selfies, group shots, buildings, things;anything and everything she had thought looked remotely interesting.

And as she progressed through the night, Enid couldnt help but qietly notice a trend in her pictures. ~~b~~W ednesday's face and figure began popping up more and more until she went from merely being in the backdrop to the picture's main subject.

Choosing to ignore the significance of that for the moment, Enid backed out of looking at the photos individually and instead as a wall of thumbnails. Scrolling to the end of her roll ~~a~~nd qietly admitting it would have been more efficient to start at the end and work backwards from the get-go ~~th~~e blonde felt her brow furrow when *none* of the photo or video thumbnails looked anything remotely like a wedding ceremony. She saw things she definitely recogniz~~e~~d— including the Korean barbecue rodeo ~~b~~ut nothing that suggested someone was saying 'I do.' And while Enid didnt think she could have taken any recording of the ceremony itself on her own, she could easily imagine herself asking a chapel employee to do it for her.

Or at the very least take selfies of her and Wednesday before and after the fact.

"Anything?" W ednesday asked, attending to the last of the marks.

"No. Which is ~~y~~*w* out of character for me. I've never known myself to be so absolutely wasted Icouldnt even take pictures. T errible, blurry, pointed the wrong way pics, sure;but *nev~~e~~r* not at all. And to not do it at my own *~~w~~eddi ng* of all things?"

"The odds do appear very low ," W ednesday commented, eyeing the multitude of thumbnails on the screen.

Wednesday pointed to the topmost thumbnail;a selfie of Enid with a play icon overlaid on her face. "Perhaps that video will contain some manner of clue?"

"Perhaps,"Enid hummed back, clicking on it-

And *i mmedi tel y* balking at the play time as the video and controls overtook the screen.

"*Fuhous?* What the fuck could Ipossibly have-"Enid cut herself off, she and Wednesday sharing a look.

The wedding.

Leaning in so closely together they nearly touched, Wednesday and Enid each took a reflexive breath as the blonde tapped play.

"[Y okooooo-]"the Enid in the video whined as the phone's camera shook slightly;she was looking blearily just below the camera lens, swaying slightly in place, and appeared to be standing on a sidewalk somewhere in the city, "[Y oko, th's sucks!Imma- Imma *sue* th's city! Tell Div!Th' s is false advtisemht!Th' *f uk?* ]"

"Do you often record yourself as if you are talking to T anaka?" Wednesday asked, her mouth twitching as it considered whether it wanted to sneer or not.

"No,"Enid admitted with a long sigh, "think my drunk ass thought I was facetiming her."

"Ah,"she nodded, "..."

Enid paused the video, "Facetiming is when you call someone and you use the cameras in the phone to see each other while you talk."

"Oh. That actually sounds rather useful."

"*Mm*" Enid nodding, restarting the video.

[th' s is an injustisice! An' *rude!*] Past-Enid slurred and gestured with her free hand, [Th' stupd chapel we found sucks *ass,* Yoks! They wouldnt- wouldnt even- *Oh shi t* Wher' da fuck th' s pole com' from? *Fuck!*]

"Do you always swear this much when intoxicated?"

"...Y eeaaahhhh," she sighed, listening to her past-self curse at a lightpole she'd bumped into with her swaying, "At least when Im upset about something."

She spent a moment wondering what had set her off as the video continued.

[*f uck asdumb* Th' stupd chapl wouldnt marry W ens and I] Past-Enid raved; making her current self freeze, W ednesday likewise going stock still.

[They said we were too- too drunk! I am *not* too drunk! They're too drunk! Rude ass fuckin-"] she continued to rant and cuss out the chapel, but the words couldnt quite manage to make it through the static building in Enid's ears.

'wouldnt marry W ens and I'

*Will dnt hmnsadl*

*Will dnt-* The words echoed on repeat in her head, the slur coming and going with every other repetition. It took several blinks, but the meaning of the words finally hit home just as a new voice came up in the video.

[cant believe they wouldnt le' me marry W ens]

[Then well jus' have to be engaged instead.]

Blinking back into something like awareness, present Enid looked at her phone to see last night's Wednesday looking equally disheveled and blurry-eyed as the blonde was appear in view; her

own past self *somehow* managing to keep both of them in the camera's frame.

[W ens! Y ou're back! W ait- Where'd you go. Don't go!]

[I'm not. I'm here. An' I got these.]

She held up her hands and there, pinched between her fingers were-

"Our rings," Present-Enid said flatly .

*[ Eeee!* Where did you get dese?]

[The ch'pel.]

[W ere they 'xpensive?]

[I ha' a discount.]

Enid blinked and looked at the Wednesday beside her, "Y ou did?"

"I'm sure I meant a five-finger discount," W ednesday answered without taking her eyes off the screen, where her counterpart was struggling to slip a ring onto a very excited Enid.

"A what?"

"I mean I probably stole them from the case; their security looked fairly simple."

"Of course you did," Enid chuckled despite herself.

[Eni', I swear to you on my blood, tha' I will give you the famly you deserve,] Past-W ednesday swore drunkenly on the phone, [One tha' will love you as you are; col'rs and all.]

[A w, Wens!] Past-Enid whined, sounding on the verge of tears. The camera swung into an odd angle as she threw her arms around

Past-Wednesday and both of their present counterparts blushed as the sounds of kissing occurred.

[Wha'you wanna do now , *f i aee?* ] Past-Enid asked.

[hav'an idea,] Past-W ednesday chuckled before saying something too low for the microphone to catch.

[..eh yeah] Past-Enid chuckled, the world pitching violently before going dark again.

"...What happened?" W ednesday asked from beside Enid as the sound of the city continued but the screen remained dark.

Enid furrowed her brow, "I think I put my phone in my pocket? Hold on let me just-"

She dragged the cursor forward along the video's progress bar, releasing it about an hour later to-

*[" A* YES YES YES! R TH ER- *K* WENS"]

Enid stabbed her index so hard against the pause button she'd have gone straight through the screen had her claws been out. Her ears and cheeks felt so hot she thought she could fry a quick snack on them.

"...W ell!" she said, pointedly looking anywhere except at the ravenette next to her, "That explains why my battery was so low this morning; c-camera must have kept recording until the battery saver kicked in and auto-stopped it."

Wednesday made an acknowledging sound and a reflexive glance her way showed the smaller woman looking far more alive than she had all day long her face had darkened so much in a blush. Enid had half a second to think how cute it made her look before her mind's eye was invaded by further scenes from last night.

*Specifically* when her hands had been on Wednesday's head as the smaller woman tried her best to drink her dry from between her legs.

The blonde feared her cheeks were in danger of setting off the smoke alarm.

The two sat in a thick silence for longer than Enid cared to admit.

"Sooooo...Looks like you were right," she said when the quiet finally became too much.

"Hm?"

"We aren't married. We...were never married."

"...Indeed."

The silence came back tenfold, and the blonde felt like she couldn't even breathe.

"I, uh, I gotta- Use the bathroom," Enid said, standing shakily and shoving her phone into her pocket, "Be right back."

As she left the common room, she missed how Wednesday's eyes followed her back.

Or how they drifted down to her newly bespeckled arm.

Enid closed the bathroom door with a small click, pressing her palm against it for a few extra moments before pulling away. Shuffling across the room she plopped herself down on top of the closed toilet seat and dragged her hands back through her hair, resting her elbows atop her knees.

She took one deep breath, held it, blew it out, and then repeated the process until her heart stopped trying to hulk-smash out through her ribs.

*Alright*

*Oa .*

*Ti sh Ti si sgood.*

*Wei not ed.*

*Ther snoone hab sy Ad se ek s.*

*Ea wei not ed.*

*Wei not*

*Se' snot if e.*

*Ad mot s.*

*mot*

Enid's heart clenched, and she found out the hard way that, somehow, someway, she had quietly become attached to a name that, in every way that mattered, wasnt hers.

She was Enid Sinclair.

*ot* Enid Addams.

*Oh my* ***Mon,*** *Enid!* She quietly groaned, rubbing roughly at her face and blamed that for the moisture she felt well in her eyes, *Ea f uk i ngg r pW an t i sh h aus pen al dy ki ngon? W el l , a i def om nen ae se ai ngf or f uk i ng* ***K n S why?***

*Wh oes i t ut som ub?*

The blonde took a few more breaths, and tried to herd her thoughts into some kind of order. She went back through the events of the day from the second she woke up needing to puke to now, trying to find the moment when things changed. When she went from trying to find the chapel because she didnt want to be married, to-

Enid's eyes snapped open as her entire being froze in place. She didn't so much as *breathe* until her lungs began protesting the lack of oxygen.

Because as hard as she searched through her memories, she couldn't recall ever *actually* wanting to *not* be married.

Yes, she and Wednesday had a less than stellar "first meeting" in the ravenette's hotel room, *and* Enid had found her to be somewhat rude and aggravating at times, but...throughout the day she had never *once* wished to be away from the psychic's company. She'd actually, rather *enjoyed* being with her today, even while hungover and traipsing halfway across Sin City in the summer sun.

Wednesday was intelligent and witty;with a bone dry sense of humor that Enid was shocked by how much she appreciated it. She was also objectively beautiful, in a haunted, demon-possessed doll kind of way, which somehow came around again to being cute.

She also had the vibe of someone who would stab anyone who called her such, but Enid *liked* how feisty she could be. How she was completely and unapologetically *herself.*

How she had looked at Enid's claws—ones the blonde *knew* could rip through sheet metal—and had been *fascinated* instead of afraid.

Enid leaned back against the toilet and thought about what she *actually* wanted. How she wanted the rest of the day, of the trip, of her *life* to go.

It took less than three minutes for her to come to a conclusion.

While it was still *entirely* too soon for marriage—and she was completely fine with this trip having no lasting legal ramifications—she still liked the idea of continuing to have Wednesday Addams in her life.

If not as a romantic partner, then at least as a friend.

...Though she would *eh al y* prefer the former, if she was being fully honest with herself. But it wasnt exactly a deal breaker .

Mind made up, Enid stood from the toilet, washed her hands ~~-s~~he didnt trust any bathroom Kent had used ~~a~~nd yanked the door open. She marched through it with the hope that by the time she reached the common room her mouth or mind would have come up with the right order of words that would get Wednesday to try going out on a proper date with her.

~~H~~r mind had ultimately settled on asking the ravenette out to dinner , but the words never left her mouth.

Because the common room she returned to was explicitly *l ~~a~~i ng* in one small dark-eyed psychic.

"W ednesday?" Enid called, looking around to see if the ravenette had simply moved to the kitchen or maybe the side table to await her return.

She hadnt.

Instead all she found was a piece of paper on the counter;the hotel provided stationary covered in looping old school styled handwriting that took Enid a long minute to be able to read.

By the time she finished reading the note for the third time, she wished she hadnt.

*Eni d,*
*I ~~a~~pec t ~~a~~ou pl ~~a~~nc ~~a~~f i ~~y~~ngl ~~a~~ni ght se~~e~~ns ~~a~~dl i ~~e~~v*
*noi ~~w~~s ~~h~~ei de ~~a~~t m ~~e~~f ou ~~s~~ opl ~~a~~see no ~~a~~nef i t nour*
*ont nuedpl ~~a~~es ~~h~~i pj us ~~a~~no ~~e~~a ~~a~~nef i ~~a~~sef om our*
*m~~e~~et ng.*
*I ~~a~~ol ogi ~~e~~f o ~~a~~ya ~~a~~dl h ~~a~~mp ~~e~~sene i ngour i f ~~e~~a ~~s~~edyou*
*dur ngt ~~h~~edu ~~a~~ion of ou pox m i t yone ~~a~~ot ~~h~~er f ~~e~~ay*
*pol ongedon ~~e~~a ~~e~~ent ~~h~~e ~~o~~f usi ~~w~~ l onl ~~y~~ngyou*
*ont nued ~~a~~dpossi ~~b~~y ~~e~~a ~~h~~a T om ~~s~~upr sel donot ~~w~~sh*

*f oh i s.*
*I genui nel ywshyoueul l Ei dadf omhai t et meeha*
*spentogeheanf i denyouwl l peseei nhaer*
*endeayoubooseopusue.Y ouaf aongeadmoe*
*onni nghayuspi nel essf ai l youl deecompehend.*
*Thaepr dei nthef ayaudi dnoteedmei nyour i f eosupas*
*youpi t f ul pant'epeaonsadasubyouwl l noteedme*
*now.*
*Godbyei d.*
*Sneel y ,*
*Wednesdayadas*

---

Given that it was the middle of the afternoon, most guests of the Parker Hotel were naturally out and about doing touristy things.

Still there were enough people on the floors on, above, and below the room one Yoko Tanaka had gotten for the front desk to later receive several complaints about someone yelling out at the top of their lungs:

"*Oh*

Chapter End Notes

> Chapter 8 (the epilogue) is done, and Ihope to finish 7 before the month is out
> Comments make the writing imps work faster but questions on when updates are going to happen make them do the opposite
>
> Again, thank you for your patience, and Ihope you enjoyed~

# Chapter 7

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Wednesday's hotel room door fell shut behind her with a dull click. She stood in the entryway for far longer than necessary, feeling a little lost on what to do next.

Taking stock of her physical being, for a lack of anything else to do, she noted the beginnings of a headache. She debated on letting it grow ~~if~~ only to do have something to focus on ~~b~~ut ultimately decided she didnt feel like dealing with it on top of sulking.

Not that she was *sul ki ng*. No. That would be absurd.

Sulking would imply she felt bad about something, and she did not. She made a perfectly logical decision;one that was the best choice for everyone involved.

She had no regrets.

And her choice to grab a small bottle of vodka to pour into her coffee as she pulled the latter from the fridge had nothing to do with any other decision she had already made that day.

Neither was grabbing a second bottle after seeing the two used mugs sitting rinsed out and drying next to the sink.

Carrying her new mug of spiked coffee, Wednesday meandered across the room, considering if it would be advisable to move up her daily scheduled writing session. She had just reached her trunk, which held her traveling typewriter, when a glint of light caught her eye.

There, sitting in a small half-dried puddle of dish soap, was her- *the* ring. The one she, whilst heavily intoxicated, had deigned to steal for herself and Enid to wear.

Because she had wanted them to be-

Wednesday was jolted out of her thoughts by a knock at the door. Nearly dropping the ring ~~a~~nd unsure of when it had replaced her cup in her hand ~~s~~he quickly placed it back onto her nightstand before striding rapidly to the door.

She ripped it open to find-

"Hi W ednesday," Pugsley greeted with his typical grin, "I thought I heard you come back."

Wednesday sagged, unable to even muster enough energy to slam the door shut in her brother's face. Instead she simply aimed herself back towards her cup of coffee, hearing Pugsley let himself in behind her.

"Have any luck finding your chapel?"

"W e did," she stated flatly , retrieving her mug, "And as I suspected, we were never actually married."

"Oh shit, really?"

"No; my drunk-self merely stole the rings for us to wear ."

"Huh. Didn't see that coming," he hummed. "Alright then; so where is she?"

"With the rest of her party , I suppose," W ednesday half-sighed, quietly berating herself for not clarifying which 'she' her brother could have been referring to.

"Oh. Cool. Are we catching up with them later then?"

Wednesday's brow furrowed and she turned back towards Pugsley. "What? No? Why would we?"

"Cause they're *f un* and you *eal y* like Enid?" he asked, giving her an odd look; as if the answer should have been obvious.

Wednesday felt her headache begin to worsen.

"Pugsley , one drunken night stand does *not* make for the start of a great relationship," she grumbled, rubbing at a temple with her free hand.

"*bl* but it *does* make for a great story to tell at your wedding-"

"-WE *W* MAR D!" W ednesday screamed, coffee sloshing everywhere as both arms slammed downward in time with her stomped foot.

"*Whoa* Pugsley yelped, taking a step back with his hands up, "Chill!"

"*I* ...m sorry , Ijust..."

"Did you- Did you just *pol ogi e* to me?"

"...t seems to be a reoccurring event today ."

Wednesday watched as her brother's face went pale, and she couldnt even find it in her to enjoy it.

"W ednesday; where is Enid?"

She shook her head, looking away, "t doesnt matter ."

"Y es it does-"

"*bl* it doesnt," she said, walking by him to return her now empty mug to the kitchen, "W e are *not* together, Pugsley, and that is for the best."

"Why?"

"Because you and I both know that I would be terrible for her. I would hurt her; I *have* hurt her!" The image of Enid's arm flashed through her mind and Wednesday *winced.* "I literally woke up and held a knife to her throat this morning!"

"That's normal, though! You still set booby traps around my room?"

"It's *not* normal for Enid!"

"Maybe. But Enid's tough, she can handle it!"

"I said no, Pugsley!" Wednesday snapped, whirling to face him, "She has already been through so much! She doesn't deserve the likes of *me!* She deserves someone who can actually make her happy!"

Pugsley scoffed and rolled his eyes, "What and you don't think you can't be that person for her?"

"I don't think that; *I know it.*"

"Bullshit. And I can prove it."

"Wh- how could you *possibly* prove it?" Wednesday demanded as her brother pulled out his phone and began tapping at it.

"Like this," he said, tossing her the device. She caught it reflexively and saw the screen was already playing a video.

"What is this?" she asked, gesturing with the piece of plastic.

"Just watch."

Wednesday sighed but presumed watching whatever insipid video her brother wanted her to see would make him leave her alone all the faster.

So she watched. And watched. And after her face shifted from annoyed to confused to something akin to amazement, she awkwardly rewound the video and watched it again simply to be sure her eyes weren't deceiving her.

They weren't.

And neither was her heart as it clenched upon realizing what she had *done.*

Both last night and today.

"I need to speak to Enid," she spat at Pugsley as she sprinted for the door; *pissing* that the blonde would even *want* to listen to her after how she had left things.

"*Hell* / *Go,* sis!" Pugsley cheered after her, "Go get your girl!"

She had just darted into the conveniently timed elevator—slamming the 'door close' button with a vengeance her Grandmama would approve of—when she heard her brother yell-

"...Hey- W ait! *Wednesday* Gimme my phone back!"

---

Throwing cash towards the front of the taxi—even though she was *sure* he had intentionally taken the long way to Enid's hotel — Wednesday dashed into the hotel lobby. Spotting one set of elevator doors closing as the only other one was clearly already near the top of the building, she cursed harshly enough that a flower vase near her immediately wilted, and barged into the stairwell instead. Taking the steps two at a time, she silently rehearsed what she would say to the wolf in her head whilst simultaneously praying to any deity that would hear her plea.

*Please let the elevator be out*

*Please let the girl be home!*

*Pease ehtead fi rstupi dmi she!*

Bursting through the stairwell door she bolted down the hallway, not halting until she came to the door she needed.

She pounded viciously on the door and would have waited for it to open with bated breath if her lungs werent so busy gasping for air .

The door opened to reveal Yoko;who took one look at W ednesday and rolled her eyes so hard they almost looked like they could have gotten stuck in place.

"Oh my god, you two are such fucking idiots,"the vampire griped as she pulled out her own phone.

"I need- *huf f*-to speak- *huf f*-to Enid,"W ednesday said as clearly as she could manage.

"Y ou two really are made for each other, Iswear ,"Y oko grumbled as she tapped at her screen.

"T anaka, *pl ease,* Iknow- *huf f*-that Imade a mistake- *huf f*-and I understand- *huf f*-if she doesnt want- *huf f*-to talk me-"

"Oh she wants to talk to you', alright!She just left to go to *your* hotel!"

"What?! She did?! Wha- Oh, *Evil hei t*" Wednesday growled as she spun around and ran back the way she came.

"I'll tell her to stay there-"she heard Y oko yell after her, "-but both of you had better *get yourshi togeher*"

---

Enid felt like she was about to lose her shit.

She was already pissed off enough over Wednesday's little 'write-n-dash' stunt, but now *thi s?*

"For the *thousandth time*—" Enid ground out through her teeth, and continuing to ignore the pinging of her phone in her back pocket, "I don't *remember* which room number it is because I was *drunk* when I got here, and *hungover* when I left! Can't you just *please* tell me which room Wednesday Addams is staying in?!"

"I'm sorry miss, but I can't give out guests information. And no one is answering when I call any of the rooms reserved under the name 'Addams,'" the tired looking concierge said to her, "I'm afraid there's not much else I can do."

Enid was about to tell him what she thought he could do—and more explicitly *where* on his body he could do it—when she heard the sound of footsteps rapidly approaching behind her.

"*Enid*!" Wednesday's voice gasped.

"Wens?! *Thank goodness!*" the blonde growled, spinning around with a glare already loaded onto her face. "I've got a bone to pick with- Are you okay?!"

The ravenette was halfway bent over, with both hands on her knees the only thing keeping her up; gasping for breath like she'd just evaded death by drowning. As she managed to look up towards Enid's face, the blonde got to watch as a trickle of sweat made its way down from her temple.

For a moment all her anger faded and left her with only the urge to wrap the smaller woman in a hug—protecting her from the world—while *also* using the shortened distance to lick the drop of sweat up.

She promptly used the embarrassment of *that* mental image to reignite her annoyance at Wednesday. It was only partially effective, as the ravenette kept gasping for air in front of her and making her look on in concern.

"What the hell happened to you?"

"Ran- *huff*-from- *huff*-your- *huff*-hotel."

"You ran- What do you *mean* you ran from my hotel?!" Enid shrieked, automatically coaxing the smaller woman to stand off to the side of the hotel's front desk when people started glaring at them, "Why the hell didn't you just take a taxi?!"

"Out- *huff*-of- *huff*-cash," Wednesday gasped, slowly straightening herself out, "And drivers- *huff*-refused- *huff*-to stop."

"Well *yeah;* probably because you look like you're running from the scene of a crime!"

Wednesday's brow furrowed. "Nonsense- *huff*-I would never do something- *huff*-so amateurish as to- *huff*-vacate a crime scene- *huff*-conspicuously."

Enid closed her brow and rubbed at one temple. "Of course you took offense- *look,* I have something to say to you, *Wednesday!* Why *the fuck* did you just leave like that?!"

"I'm sorry," the ravenette said, wincing at the reminder of what she'd done, "For both leaving- *huff*-the way I did, and for thinking- *huff*-that I had to leave at all."

"You should be; that was a shitty thing to do, Wednesday," Enid huffed, crossing her arms.

On the one hand she felt mildly pleased that she'd gotten an apology so easily from the ravenette; but on the other hand she was still miffed.

Largely because she didn't get to use the rest of the speech she'd spent the entire walk over rehearsing, but she didn't think Wednesday needed to know that just yet.

"...So what made you change your mind?" she asked instead.

Still trying to catch her breath, Wednesday reached into her back pocket and pulled out-

"You have a *phone*?"

*Oh, **actually**, yeah, I have one.*

"No- *huff*-Pugsley's," she explained, slowly tapping at it and unwittingly staying her own execution.

Curiosity getting the better of her, Enid moved around her until she could see the screen. Wednesday was scrolling tentatively through her brother's gallery, and eventually selected a video to play, holding the phone up so the blonde could see it better.

The screen showed Wednesday and Enid, leaning against a wall in a dimly lit bar that the wolf vaguely recalled from last night from just before they went to the Korean barbecue, if she wasn't mistaken. If Pugsley had been the one to take the video, he must have done it from the other side of the room, because Enid couldn't hear a word her past-self was saying, though she could see her mouth and hands moving. Past-Wednesday wasn't saying much, only nodding on occasion, but her attention was clearly focused on the blonde next to her.

What struck Enid the most as she watched the video, was how *sad* her past-self looked; her head was dipped as she kept her gaze on the floor, back fully pressed to the wall. Watching her lips she could just make out the words "family" and "wolf-out" and Enid had the sinking feeling that she had been explaining her status as a lone wolf to Wednesday.

*Oh, **that's** why she looked so sad*, she wondered, *because they're not here*

*We're all right here, Enid, we're not going anywhere, I promise*

t seemed like drunk-her was on the verge of tears-to sober-hers embarrassment -when the W ednesday in the video finally made a move. Straightening up from the wall, she raised a hand to Enid's cheek and made her look her way. Again, no words were caught by the mic, but the ravenette looked *very* serious about whatever it was she was saying. When she was done speaking, she pulled the blonde-who had been staring awestruck at her in much the same way the present version was at the phone close enough to press their foreheads together;making past-Enid break out into a massive grin that past-Wednesday's hand failed to completely block from the camera.

[A ww, loo-look at the love-birds~]Kent' s drunken voice said suddenly, making current-Enid jump.

[Y eah,]Pugsley' s voice slurred, also sounding very drunk, [I'm gla'W ednesday made a frien~]

Enid's brow furrowed as Wednesday paused the video just as their past selves wrapped each other up in a tight looking hug.

"..Didnt winning your bet with Pugs mean that he was supposed to be *sober* the rest of the night?"

"Y es, but proof of my brother's cheating was not the point of the video,"W ednesday said, her breathing finally returned to normal.

"So what *was* the point, then?"

"I..am admittedly far from adept when it comes to feelings,"the ravenette confessed, unable or unwilling to meet Enid's eye, "I have been told that Iam brash and harsh and incapable of causing any positive feeling to anyone who Iam not already family to. Usually , I dont mind this. Itake pride in it even;in my ability to cause pain to others. But you..."

Her head turned and Enid followed her gaze straight down to her left arm, which, in her opinion, already looked far better than it had

earlier.

"...For some reason that I still don't fully understand, I *don't* want to hurt you. And because I managed to have done so both physically and emotionally today, though unintentionally, I thought that meant that the only way to *not* hurt you, was to remove myself completely from the equation."

Enid could see the logic - stupid as it was - especially since she'd already written as much in her note; but that didn't erase the anger and hurt she felt at the raven-ette's running away. Not completely, at least.

"...And this video of us last night was enough to change your mind?" Enid asked.

"Y es. Enid I was so drunk last night that I do not even *remember* the moment captured on this infernal device," she stated, waving said device around, "And yet, *somehow*, my inebriated-self still managed to comfort you - to make you *smile* like that - even whilst you were evidently reciting a painful part of your life."

Wednesday bit her lip, and lifted her chin to look Enid in the eye.

"If I could do that while drunk, then - then perhaps I could do the same thing while sober."

"...Y ou mean it?"

"I do. I won't lie to you, it will probably take some time" -

"I don't care," Enid spat out, shaking her head, "I spent all day with you while you were stone cold sober and I *still* didn't want you to leave. I think you're funny and smart and while it is *way* too fucking soon for marriage, I'd love the chance to get to know you better. I *want* to know you better, Wens; even if I am still a little mad at how you ditched me."

"Because I shouldn't have. It was wrong. *I* was wrong. We may not need each other in our lives, but I realize now that does not mean I'm not allowed to want you. ...If you'll have me?"

Enid barked out a laugh, making Wednesday's shoulders droop relaxedly at the sound and the sight of her smile.

"Just try to get rid of me, Wednesday Addams."

"Same to you, Enid Sinclair."

Enid grinned before deciding "To hell with it" and yanked the ravenette into a hug. To her delight, Wednesday returned the embrace after only a moment's hesitation.

She felt perfectly shaped for Enid's arms, and the blonde couldn't help but nuzzle their heads together.

"*Holy shit!*"

The pair turned their heads towards the voice—both of them glaring *mad* growling at being interrupted—and found Pugsley, standing mere yards away, with his arms full of snacks, having evidently just walked out of the hotel's shop.

"Something to say, *dear brother*?"

"Yeah! Congratulations you two!" he grinned, stepping closer, "I was hoping you two would straighten things out!...Though maybe 'straight' isn't the right word here."

"I will garrot you with your own tongue, *Pugsley*," Wednesday growled; though notably she made no move to leave her hug with Enid. Pugsley grinned like he was like he was about to *point out* that particular fact, and Enid decided she'd just a soon skip the attempted murder in broad daylight.

"Thanks, Pugs!" she chirped quickly, slightly increasing her hold on Wednesday, "What are all the snacks for?"

"Oh these?" he asked, hoisting the numerous bags of chips, pretzels, and candies, "W ell I figured if you and W ednesday got back together then that meant we'd probably hang out with the rest of the gang, too! And I thought, hey! I'll grab some snacks for tonight' s pre-game! and here I am!"

"Oh that' s so sweet of you, Pugs," Enid smiled; feeling slightly queasy at the thought of going out again after last night.

"Thanks! The shop here kinda sucks though; I couldn't find bats, mice, or even *bugs* to eat!" Pugsley grumbled, "high class hotel, my ass."

"Y eah, that- that defintely sucks," Enid winced, fighting to keep a smile on her face. She'd forgotten about the 'eccentricies' of the rest of the Addams family.

Not that she was going to let her deter her just yet.

"Pugsley , Enid and I were in the middle of what I believe is called 'a moment'," W ednesday huffed, "W ould you be so kind as to walk into traffic and leave us alone?"

"Give me phone back and I'll be on my dreary little way ," Pugsley quipped, somehow managing to free up one of his hands from beneath the pile of snacks. Wednesday ignored it completely, choosing instead to lob his phone directly at his face like it was a dagger.

She huffed when he caught it neatly between his teeth.

"Good catch, Pugs!"

"hanks, Eni! See 'ou 'ater!" Puglsey mumbled, turning and making his way towards the lobby's elevators. 'n true Las V egas fashion, no one batted a single eye at a man walking around with his arms full of snacks or a phone in his mouth.

"So...how ...does this work?" Wednesday asked as they finally separated from each other.

Enid cocked her head, "What do you mean?"

"I mean how do we...date?" she explained, face twitching like she had just caught a whiff of something she wasn't sure she liked the smell of, "What do people even do?"

"Oh!" Enid hummed, thinking it over, "Well, they do things like, hang out together. Walk around doing things. Have food together. You know just, enjoy each other's company."

"That's all?" We did all of that today. *And* last night."

"And you were *great* for all of it," Enid grinned, "See? Nothing to worry about! You're a natural at this already!"

"I suppose I had to glean *something* from my parent's infuriating ways after all these years," Wednesday chuckled, which quickly turned into a small yawn.

"You okay?"

"I'm fine. It's just been a very long day. And I didn't get to finish my last cup of coffee."

"...You know, couples *also* take naps together?"

"A nap, huh," Wednesday deadpanned, one brow rising.

"*Just* a nap, I swear!" the blonde said, waving her hands.

"Mhm."

"Oh, don't even," Enid huffed, walking in the same direction Pugsley had left in, Wednesday matching her step for step, "You were *just* as vocal in that video as I was!"

The ravenette's brow furrowed, "How could you tell from the few seconds we—...You listened to more of it, didn't you."

"I- It auto-played when I opened my gallery again!" Enid swore; blatantly ignoring the heat rising in her cheeks.

"Mhm."

"*I did!*"

---

Enid flopped back against Wednesday's bed with a dramatic sigh.

"*Mmm,* I forgot how awesome this mattress is~" she moaned, all but wriggling in place.

"I'll be sure to tell my parents you approved," Wednesday deadpanned as she crawled more sedately onto the bed, reclining in her preferred 'coffin-corpse' fashion, "They insisted on the best for Pugsley and I's trip."

Enid giggled, shuffling across the bed until her head reached the pillows and she and the ravenette were laying side by side.

For several minutes, the odd pair laid side by side in a clothed mimicry of how they initially started the day.

Enid sighed.

"...You know what makes me sad?"

"I thought you wanted to nap," Wednesday sighed, eyes still closed, "What makes you sad?"

"How much I don't remember about last night," Enid pouted, turning her head to look at Wednesday. "What we talked about, how I wooed you-"

"I dislike the implication I was not the one doing the wooing," the ravenette huffed, one eye cracking open to lightly glare at the blonde.

"Said the one who hates romance so much," Enid teased before her smile dimmed slightly, "But out of everything, what I regret forgetting the most was our first kiss."

"...Oh?"

"Yeah," she sighed, turning back towards the ceiling once more, "Where was it? Did I start it? Did *you?* Was it a good one-"

Enid felt something *soft* press against her cheek and nearly squeaked. Turning her head slowly after it had pulled away, she looked back at Wednesday.

"...I also do not recall anything about the first time I kissed you," the ravenette said, returning to her previous position, "So I'm afraid I will simply have to settle for remembering the first time I kissed you *today*."

Enid felt her face erupt into what was undoubtedly a vibrant pink. It was almost reflecting off of the pale of Wednesday's cheek as she scoffed at the blonde.

"Really?" she asked, eyebrow raised again, "After *everything* I can recall that we did ~~in~~ in this very bed, no less ~~a~~ a simple kiss on the cheeks makes you blush?"

"S-Shut up!" Enid stuttered, "Anyone would blush if they got a kiss from someone as pretty as you!"

Wednesday huffed, "Your beauty is equal to my own, but I doubt *I* would blush so easily."

"...Alright; *but*"

"What-"

In one swift movement Enid rolled on top of her;planting her hands on either side of Wednesday's head as she kneeled over top of the ravenette. Wednesday looked up at her, surprised written plainly across her face.

"This okay?" Enid asked.

"...It's fine."

"You sure?"

"Yes."

"Really? Cause I know I said bet' but I don't want to push you into-"

"Enid if you don't *shut up and kiss me*—"

"Okay okay!" Enid said, "Jeez *Bossy*"

Leaning down, the blonde only paused for half a moment before gently pressing her lips against Wednesday's, both of their eyes falling shut. She lingered for one, two, three moments, before finally pulling back.

She then couldn't help but let out a *snk.*

"What?" Wednesday demanded.

"Sorry , it's just- You're blushing so much you actually look *like a tomato* right now!" Enid giggled.

Wednesday grumbled and decided the best way to stop the giggling was to simply give Enid's mouth something better to do.

So she did.

Their second kiss ~~of~~ the day ~~th~~en easily transitioned into their third. Then their fourth. Fifth. Sixth.

Around the twentieth kiss ~~a~~nd when hands started wandering under clothes ~~th~~e pair were interrupted by Enid' s phone once more pinging repeatedly.

With dual sighs, Enid slipped the device from her pocket, checking the screen.

þYgss: if u 2 r gona hav sex lemme no so i can leave]

þYgss: i realy dont need 2 hear u 2 going like rbbits agin]

"Oh *f uk* ~~g~~*u,* Pugs!" Enid yelled towards the wall behind the headboard.

"Not that it' s inaccurate, but why is my brother's name þYgss' on your device?" W ednesday drawled.

"Listen, drunk me is not the best speller ," Enid defended as her phone pinged again.

þYgss: y?s W ednesday not satisfyying u?]

Enid and Wednesday stared at the phone for a long moment before they shared a look.

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Pugsley wasn't *onehunded* percent sure if the "fun" text he got from Enid meant the girls were going to have sex or hunt him for sport, but he chose to err on the side of caution and quickly left his room anyway.

At any rate he'd already made plans to meet up with Kent after he gotten his phone back, so he wasn't complaining too much about the sudden eviction. Mostly he was just glad his sister had managed to make a new friend in a way that didn't involve grave robbing.

Though in the future he think he would make a point of *not* taking the room next to theirs.

He had a feeling they werent going to get any calmer with age. At least not if his parents were any indication.

Chapter End Notes

The epilogue will be up tomorrow afternoon so people have time to read this chap.

# Chapter 8: Epilogue

Chapter Notes

Here we go~

See the end of the chapter for more notes

*Scarlet Sinner*

Enid heaved into the toilet and idly wondered when *the fuck* she would learn to not drink so much. She startled when something cool touched her bare shoulder;only to relax as familiar fingers began carding themselves through her hair gently.

"Are you alright, Enid?" Wednesday asked softly, voice husky after just waking up.

"Yeaahh,"the blonde groaned, spitting into the bowl, "I'm regretting letting Grandmama bring her fucking *bow* as a wedding gift for Yoko and Div though."

"Darling, there's no letting Grandmama do anything;she just– *hk"*–

Enid reflexively jerked her head out of the toilet a split second before Wednesday's own took her place.

"Aw, babe,"she cooed sympathetically, taking care to pull her girlfriend's loose hanging hair back away from her face.

"*Buhh.* In hindsight, letting Kent sit next to her was also a bad choice."

"Yeaaah, they do tend to wind each other up,"Enid sighed. She chuckled softly as Wednesday found the strength to sit back up again.

"Does my suffering amuse you?" the ravenette asked with a small smirk.

"Only when you deserve it," the wolf quipped as she leaned back against a nearby wall while Wednesday used the front of the sink to stay upright. "Nah, I was just thinking; all we need is a knife to my throat and this would be just like the day we met. Or I guess the morning after."

Wednesday blinked at her before huffing a small laugh.

"You're correct. Only this time there are no surprise rings."

"*Hehheh.* Yeah..."

"..."

"..."

They raised their hands up at the same time.

On Enid's right ring finger was the ring Wednesday had stolen for them in Las Vegas. Outside of the gym she took it off as rarely as the ravenette removed its twin from the cord she wore around her neck; tucked safely next to her heart, though Wednesday refused to admit as such.

On her *left* hand, however, was a gold band with a red gemstone set into it.

Looking up with a squeak, Enid saw that Wednesday's left had its own ring; hers silver with a blue gem.

"Oh, not again," Wednesday sighed before she and the blonde tensed up and shared not only a look but a thought as well.

They *knew* these rings.

Leaping up from the floor as quickly as their hungover bodies would allow, the pair stumbled to the door and all but fell into the room beyond.

It was a hotel room; with articles of clothing and empty bottles flung every which way around a massive bed. And *in* said bed were two bodies spooning each other as they quietly snored in the morning light cast from a nearby window.

Yoko and Divina: the completely nude newlyweds.

Enid and Wednesday each took a deep breath and sighed heavily, in-toning at the same time–

"Shit."

"We *seriously* need to stop drinking," Enid groaned, dragging her hands down her face.

"...Does helping to consummate their marriage count as another wedding gift?"

"*Wens!* ...Normally I'd say *no,* but considering it's *them* ... Maybe?"

"I see..."

"...Why?" Enid asked, not entirely thrilled with the contemplative look on her girlfriend's face.

"I'm trying to decide if I would be opposed to them returning the favor on our wedding night," Wednesday mumbled, head cocked in thought. "Though reflexively I don't like the idea of sharing you..."

"...Can we have this discussion while we have coffee?...And pants on?"

"Hm? Oh, yes. Of course," she nodded before looking at the rest of the room. Something above them caught her eye and she blinked up at it.

"...Is that—"

"My bra?" Enid drawled, having seen the same thing, "Y up."

"Why is it on the ceiling fan and not in the freezer?"

"Guess drunk-me felt like switching it up," the blonde shrugged as she walked past Wednesday and began digging through the kitchen in her hunt for coffee.

"The unplanned foursome with the newlyweds wasn't enough?" Wednesday quipped lightly, joining her after locating their respective panties and stealing two shirts from an opened suitcase.

"I mean, is it really any crazier than what we got up to in Vegas?" Enid wondered aloud, thanking her girlfriend for the clothes as the coffee began brewing.

"Hm, good point," the psychic hummed, buttoning up her shirt, "Though it really depends on whether we hit anyone last night."

"True. Or if anything caught on fire."

"Accurate."

There were several knocks at the door.

Enid and Wednesday stared at it. Glanced at the still unconscious couple. Then had a silent conversation with each other.

The knocks kept coming.

Losing the subsequent game of rock-paper-scissors—cursing and blessing her girlfriend's dexterous hands in equal measure—Enid resignedly padded her way to the hotel door. She was about to check the peephole when whoever was on the other side called through it.

"Div? Divina? C'mon, wake up! I need you!" they whisper-yelled familiarly.

Brow furrowed, Enid opened the door just enough to stick her head through.

"Kent? What's wrong?"

"Shi- Enid! Heeeey!" the long haired man cringed with a grin, "Sorry! I thought this was the, ya know, *honeymoon* suite."

"Oh it- it is," Enid confessed, clearing her throat and making sure her body was blocking as much of the room from Kent's view as it could.

"Then, what are you doing in it? Shit, *Wens* isn't with you, is she?"

The blonde felt a familiar sense of dread begin dripping down her spine. "... *Why?*"

"Uhhh, *haha*" Kent laughed awkwardly, scratching at the back of his head, "I uh- *Well I..*" He leaned in close and whispered in her ear. She closed her eyes slowly when he had finished, and counted to ten before daring to open them again.

"...You have *got* to be kidding me."

"Who is it, Enid?" Wednesday called from where she was watching the coffee machine, heedless of the sleeping newlyweds.

"*Fuck!*" Kent moaned quietly while Enid rolled her eyes.

"It's Kent. *Apparently* this morning is even more of a Vegas-repeat' than we thought."

"...And why is that?"

"Kent lost Pugsley."

"I see. Well, that is hardly the worst-"

"And Grandmama."

"...It has been established that my grandmother can take care-"

"*And* Pubert."

"Oh for fuck's sake- *Emerson!*"

"*Insolly*"

"You *lost* my youngest brother!? Pugsley and Grandmama are one thing, but *Pubert?* I am unclear on how to waterboard a siren, but I *will find out.*"

"Th'fuck is all the yellin'about?" someone's groggy voice floated from the bed.

"Hangover Part Two," Enid called casually as she joined Wednesday back in the kitchen, Kent following sheepishly behind her.

"Sugar?" Wednesday asked with a growl, passing Enid her mug.

"Yes, please."

"...Why are you three in our room?" Divina asked, voice as bleary as her eyesight, if the squinting was any indication.

"I just got here," Kent swore, hands up placatingly, "No clue why they're here so early."

"...Enid, are you wearing my shirt?"

"Only until I figure out where mine is, Yoks. Also, where did you find one that says 'save a ship, ride a siren'?"

"I made it usin'the cricket you gave me for m'birthday."

"Nice! I like the font choice!" Enid chirped, pulling the shirt away from her to admire the old timey looking font Yoko had used.

"Thnks."

"...Enid, where are your pants?"

"Hopefully near mine," Wednesday answered, filling Enid's mug with coffee and passing it over while waiting for her own.

"And neithr of you hve pants cause?"

"My guess is for the same reason neither of *you* have clothes on," Enid hummed, taking a careful sip of the hot liqid.

Her head felt like it had been beat with a hammer, but watching the realization dawn on Divina and Yoko's faces made her feel slightly better.

"Much as I love a game of 'where're my pants'," Kent interjected, "what are we gonna do about Pugs, Pubes, and G-Ma?"

Wednesday pulled her now full mug from the machine and sent a withering glare the boy's way. "Simple: *I* am going to finish this coffee, get dressed and then track down my youngest brother."

"Aw Wens, look at you," Enid cooed, "Acting so concerned about your baby brother." Her smile dimmed. "...it's kinda weird. Why are you so concerned?"

"Of course I'm concerned; Pubert swallowed something of mine, and Pugsley and I have a bet on whether I have the patience to wait for him to pass it," she huffed, downing the coffee with barely a wince, in spite of the heat. "I can't very well win if I'm not nearby to reclaim what's mine."

Enid blanched, "What in the world did he swallow?"

"...One of my family's old heirlooms," Wednesday said; doing her best to not think about how much time she had spent going through all of the treasures tucked away here and there throughout the family manor.

Or the gold ring with a hideously bright opal that she thought paired well with the blonde’s bright personality.

*O* her various plots and schemes to *gi e* said ring to Enid.

*d* deally in such a way that she would actually *emem er* having done so. And that neither of them would ever try to undo.

She took no small amount of solace from the fact that her wolf would most likely be happy with any of the plans that had so far come to mind.

Or even something a bit more, spontaneous.

Chapter End Notes

Thank you so much to everyone who's read, commented, and waited patiently for this story!
Y'all have been awesome!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!